

The Tantra Called the Vajra Flame Tongue of Vajrapāṇi, the Blue-Robed, the Fierce Great Yakṣa

Nīlāmbaradhara Vajrapāṇi Yakṣa Mahārudra Vajrānala Jihvātāntṛa nāma · Toh 461 · Derge Kangyur

ཕགྱ་ན་རྫོགས་པ་ཅན་གནད་སྒྲི་དག་པ་ཆེན་པོ་རྫོགས་ལུ་རྩ་ཅས་བ་བྱ

Toh 461 in the Kangyur is a tantric scripture known in Sanskrit as the Nīlāmbaradhara Vajrapāṇi Yakṣa Mahārudra Vajrānala Jihvātāntṛa and in Tibetan as the Vajra Flame Tongue of Vajrapāṇi, the Blue-Robed, the Fierce Great Yakṣa. It belongs to the class of action or ritual tantras and centers on Vajrapāṇi in his fierce, blue-robed form as a great yakṣa overlord, depicting him as a wrathful emanation of the Buddha presiding over vast assemblies of yakṣas and other fierce beings throughout the cosmos. The text opens with the Blessed One adopting a wrathful posture and surveying the ten directions, framing what follows as a revelation of fierce protective and ritual power associated with this form of Vajrapāṇi. As Toh 461 in the Kangyur, it is preserved among the tantric scriptures of the Tibetan Buddhist canon.

In the language of India: Nīlāmbaradhara Vajrapāṇi Yakṣa Mahārudra Vajrānala Jihvātāntṛa nāma. In the language of Tibet: The Tantra Called the Vajra Flame Tongue of Vajrapāṇi, the Blue-Robed, the Fierce Great Yakṣa.

Homage to the noble Vajrapāṇi.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling within the bhaga of the sovereign mother who is the source of all things. At that time ten billion fierce yakṣas, together with all the fierce and wrathful classes of beings throughout the great trichiliocosm of world-systems, were gathered in one place.

Then the Blessed One assumed the wrathful cross-legged posture, raised his right hand toward the sky, stretched his left hand down toward the earth, and, turning his gaze, looked in all ten directions. From his mouth there burst forth a great sound: the cry "Hūṃ Ha!" Thereupon all the assembled retinue fainted and remained for a long time insensible, their sovereign lord nowhere to be seen.

At that very instant, from the crown of the Blessed One's head, one called Vajrapāṇi — the image of the hand bearing the vajra, granted by all the buddhas, lord of the three classes of mantra, renowned for his deep blue color

— who holds a nine-pointed vajra in his right hand and a fierce king of garuḍas in his left, plunged into the great ocean. Then, moving the wings of that garuḍa, he entered the ocean. The nāga kings Nanda and Upananda bowed their heads before their own lord. Joyful Companion and Conch-Bearer made earrings for him. Kulikā adorned him as a neck ornament. Padma and Mahāpadma became his bracelets. Cloud-Force bound itself at his ear as a topknot clasp. Hulu Hulu became his girdle. Thunderclap and Destroyer of Māra became his anklets and then returned to the left hand of their lord.

Then the ten billion yakṣas and all the wrathful classes, rousing themselves from their swoon, looked in every direction and saw Vajrapāṇi, the image of the hand bearing the vajra, abiding within the great ocean. With wonder they cried out: "Aho! Alala! Our sovereign lord himself is present!" And so saying, they went and approached him.

When they looked, they beheld one who was supremely fierce: his hair standing upright in a mass, his eyes blazing like heaps of firebrands, his fangs bared, his tongue flickering like lightning, his belly coiled like a pond. He stood with the depth of the ocean — eighty thousand leagues — reaching only to his knees. He was adorned with the seven ornaments of the nāgas. In his right hand he held a nine-pointed vajra; in his left, a fierce king of garuḍas. His body, radiant, measured two hundred and sixty thousand leagues.

Then the yakṣas made this petition: "Lord, may you please explain the fierce secret meaning at length to the Blessed One, for we ourselves did not dare to request it." Having said this, they offered Vajrapāṇi a blue upper robe dyed in molten vaiḍūrya, and bound six thousand tiger skins about him as a lower garment.

Then Vajrapāṇi went with wonder before the presence of the Blessed One, touched his head to the Blessed One's feet, and sat down in front of him in the cross-legged posture with full presence of mind. The Blessed One then gazed upon the sky and the earth and looked with his eye sweeping all around through the intermediate space. He then pronounced the mantra: "Khaṃ Thuṃ Saṃ." Thereupon Vajrapāṇi rose from his seat, pressed his vajra-joined palms to his own heart, and addressed the Blessed One in these words:

"O Blessed One, for the benefit of myself and all sentient beings, I request the fierce secret meaning. Does the Blessed One grant permission to ask?" The Blessed One, without saying anything, entered into meditative absorption in the samādhi known as "Certainly Taming the Host of the Wicked."

The very instant he entered that meditative absorption, every malevolent being dwelling in the great thousandfold world system of the three thousand worlds was seized with a trembling of the heart. Then the Blessed One arose from that meditative absorption, gazed upon Vajrapāṇi, and with his left hand drew forth the heartwood of the water-tree and bent it inward. With the water-tree of arising he fully extended it with a sound, and remained thus. Thereupon Vajrapāṇi, recognizing that very mudrā precisely, spoke these words: "You and the rest of the retinue — do not remain in this place; depart to another direction! If you do not go, your hearts and those of your retinue will be split asunder." At these words, the assemblies that obstruct through the apertures of sound departed and took their places as before.

This concludes the first chapter, the setting chapter, from the Tantra of the Vajra Flame: Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Garment.

Then Vajrapāṇi
addressed the body of the Sage in these words:
"I pray you, explain to me at length
the meaning of the fierce secret vajra.

O Lord of Secrets, listen well,
take this to heart, I pray you.
What is my secret, and what is
the fierce vajra —
I have no other defining characteristic besides these.
Set forth your own tantra
and explain the actions of your deeds.

Sentient beings encompassed by the four births,
tormented by malevolent ones —
explain with certainty the defining mark
of the skillful repulsion.

The syllable BA is the body of Vairocana;
the syllable JA is the body of Akṣobhya, the Sage;
the syllable RA is the body of Ratnasambhava —
these three syllables of the Flame:
the first, the principal, is to be explained.

PĀ is the destroyer of vajra;
ṆA is the destroyer of lotus;
I is the destroyer of all movement —

these three subscripts are joined at the end of the name.

E fully comprehends all;

RA is that which ripens;

PA is the gatherer of all;

SA performs the function of universal support;

YA is explained as setting in true motion.

Those endowed with sense organs, abiding above the second aperture-opener, are to be known as the noble ones.

From that, through definitive arising,

whatever appearance is Vairocana's is joined to the actuality.

In all the branch-methods of those

who enter into the actuality of intention,

what was stated above is here expressed.

For the sake of clear meaning, the words repeated need not be elaborated at length.

For the forms accomplished through action,

the fierce is fully taught;

and since it is explained chiefly for yakṣas

who bear spears and weapons,

the words are definitively and correctly stated.

Through your joyful holding of the scriptural transmission,

that very [teaching] is one that has arisen in accord with your lineage;

all likewise delight in fierce action.

Though they do not see appearance as pure,

that very suchness is to be definitively stated.

Whatever was taught above

applies without doubt to each one individually.

When accomplished by means of those various applications,

the various prosperities that appear

become manifest, expansive, and clearly certain.

The great appearance, free of self,

is thoroughly established through the continuum.

The higher words of conventional truth

are seen as like relying on things.

Like the lower sound of ultimate truth,

all afflictions are burned away and,
by intrinsic nature,
abide in luminosity.

For entering the essence and ultimate truth,
one must rely upon the subsequent conventional.
At the outset, do not abide in the buddha-state,
but strive to engage in the actions of the former person.
Hold no conceit about having obtained empowerment.
From the definitive oral instructions of the guru,
serve the guru oneself
with veneration to the best of one's ability.

The vajra, which is the nature and source of all,
and whatever burns away all that is malevolent —
the higher sound of entering actuality
is expressed as the higher word."

This concludes the second chapter, the chapter of definitive words, from the
Tantra of the Vajra Flame: Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Garment.

Then Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Garment
addressed the Blessed Buddha in these words:
"Please speak the maṇḍala of method
for what is to be accomplished."

The King of Awareness (Skt. vidyārāja) declared:

When the ultimate reality becomes manifest in actuality,
the maṇḍala deities are without form.
Because beings abide in conceptual thought,
and in order to dispel their mass of projections,
the practice of the deities shall be explained.

One who performs this with devotion
should establish a maṇḍala of three cubits, with four sides,
in a grove, a charnel ground, an empty house,
a temple, or at a stūpa —
one should begin it decisively in one of these places.

First, having entered the preliminary approach practice,
one performs a festival of sixteen maidens.

For three days one should bathe oneself,
and on the crown, the armpit, and the heart
one should inspect the syllables of the three secrets.
On cloth dyed with the appropriate dye,
apply saffron drops with precision,
then put it on.

As food, the three white substances should be offered,
and one should not encounter any man.
By reciting this very essence mantra
one hundred thousand times by oneself, one draws forth the awareness.

Then, when the approach practice is complete,
one speaks words to the maiden herself.
Lac, the five kinds of wax,
rām dye, and indigo bark — all combined —
are purchased without regard for price,
and wrapped within cloth of a matching kind;
she entrusts to oneself whatever is its dwelling place.
By engaging with her over three days
with the precise mudrā,
and using the practice of the essence mantra as before —
applying perfumed water and completing the prescribed count —
one should recite perfectly.

Then the blue thread
properly wound by the maiden,
purified by mantra and made beautiful,
is to be twisted assuredly into nine strands.
Wrapped within blue flowers,
all five khadira-wood pegs
are used to inscribe the thread throughout.
With a precise and settled measure,
speaking words over the mudrā,
placing it evenly in meditative equipoise —
the maṇḍala has been properly made.

With a height of one cubit,
beginning from the northeast corner first,

take the supporting base in the corresponding color of the appropriate class,
and compress it in its entirety with certainty.

The second is precisely a double measure.

The third has the measure of one.

Made with such proportional measures,
they are to be perfectly and evenly stretched.

Following that same procedure,

with the first thread

draw lines in yellow.

From the determined nine-part maṇḍala,

taking grain, earth, jewels,

and powder as designated,

in the center draw a lotus with sixteen petals

facing downward.

In the east, south, west, and north,

and likewise in the intermediate directions, draw the same.

The lotus of the le-tse variety

is correctly described as variegated.

In the intermediate directions, place in full

the goddess of offering.

At the four gates, the four wrathful goddesses

are to be properly arranged in their practice.

With jeweled ornamental fringe, offerings of desire,

and lattice-work and half-lattice complete,

adorned with four toraṇa archways,

resting on a base of various vajras —

parasols and deer, whatever of these belong,

adorned in full with all ornaments.

The mantra practitioner possessed of an awakening mind,

adorned with a garland of bones

and a garland of serpent heads,

and beautifully encircled on the outside

by a garland of blazing multicolored vajras —

in the four corners draw four vases

perfectly complete with their ornaments.

In the center of that maṇḍala is Vajrapāṇi himself,
dwelling in full according to his earlier described form.
In the east, Sarvavid Vairocana, the Conqueror of the Three Realms,
is to be drawn correctly.

His color is red,
with a form of three faces and six arms.
He stands with four legs, some extended and some drawn in.
The right hand holds a vajra with certainty,
the left is adorned with a battle-axe.
The middle two hands, those that bind,
have the ring finger and thumb knotted with certainty,
while the others are fully extended.
That same essence mantra
is grasped correctly at the heart.
Below, the right hand holds a lasso,
the left hand holds a sword.
This is the first one to be placed.

In the south is the Great Black One,
his color like a smoke-dark cloud,
with a form of one face and two arms.
The male holds sandalwood and great bliss,
the female fully grasps a lasso.
With a wrathful face of unbearable aspect,
he gazes out into all ten directions.
That very protector, whoever he may be,
is placed in the second direction.

For the third placement, in the western direction:
the great and mighty son of hideous body,
his color entirely green,
with eyes that are slightly wide.
One face, two arms,
the crown adorned with a vajra helmet.
The right hand holds a vajra,
the left grasps the hide of a mongoose.
The two feet stand perfectly upright,
gazing toward the east, he abides fully.

For the fourth placement, in the northern direction:
he who abides amid swirling nectar,
his color thoroughly blue,
with a face fierce, scowling, and magnificently wrathful.
Right drawn in, left extended — the stance of power.
The two hands are crossed firmly at the chest,
and he gazes slightly but with certainty to the left.
Facing south, he is to be correctly placed.

In the northeast: the Vajra Yakṣa,
his color a fearsome dark red.
Right extended, left drawn in, he abides firmly,
the right hand raising a sharp curved blade,
the left striking hard with a staff.
He is to be placed gazing toward the chief figure.

In the southeast: the Vajra Zombie (vetāla),
his color a blazing blue-grey,
of unbearably blazing and terrifying form.
He gazes with certainty slightly to the right,
right extended, left drawn in, standing so.
Grasping a vajra iron-chain,
the middle three fingers — ring finger and the rest — are firmly hooked and
fully bound,
while the four thumb-and-index fingers are fully extended.
He holds them crossed with certainty at the crown of the head.

In the southwest: the Vajra Ḍākinī,
her color a reddish-white,
of utterly unbearable and terrifying form.
The two feet are planted sole-to-sole,
she is conceived as filling the four corners of the sky.
The two hands are joined palm-to-palm at the crown,
fully holding a blazing tongue of fire.
The head is adorned with five skulls.
She is to be placed shown facing the chief figure.

In the northwest: she who is called Vajra Terrifier,
her color a fearsome blue-black,
three faces, six arms,

the two feet as described above.

The first right and left hands hold fully extended elephant hide.

Below that, the right holds an enemy-axe,

the left holds a true vajra.

The third right hand holds an iron hook,

the left bears a fresh human head.

Standing in the manner of extended and drawn in,

she abides facing toward the chief figure.

At the cut corners of the boundary

are Luminosity-Producer, Mind-Stealer,

Samantabhadrā, and Melody-Bearer.

Their colors matching their respective directions,

exceedingly peaceful, with gentle, graceful mien.

In the right hand: flowers,

and incense, food offerings, and mirror images —

engaged in dance, truly replete with these.

With breasts slightly prominent,

the lower body draped in white silk,

gazing at the chief figure, their forms are beautiful.

They are to be placed in the outer corners.

At the gateways are the gate-guardians:

Life-Cutter, Breath-Drinker,

Blood-Drinker, and Flesh-Eater.

One face, two arms each,

perfectly abiding as tiger, lion, serpent,

and bear respectively.

The right hands hold a hammer, a mongoose hide,

a fire-hook, and a sharp curved blade.

The left hands each hold a lasso,

and all fully grip terrifying implements.

Their colors matching their respective directions,

each utterly scorched and black.

Left extended, right drawn in,

bodies snarling with bared fangs and fierce aspect,

faces magnificently wrathful,

abiding in great bliss through dancing posture.

Gazing slightly to the left,
they also cry out the sound "Hala! Hala!"

Furthermore, all those deities, every one of them,
are adorned with five skulls,
complete with the five ornaments,
and all are wrapped at the lower body
in tiger skin.

Above this, abiding upon their thrones,
the sun and moon circle at the shoulders
of the chief figure himself.

Brahmā, Śakra (Indra), and the Great God (Śiva) —
are trampled underfoot.

The Great God Victorious (Śiva as Vijaya) of the east
abides upon a skeleton throne.

All others likewise abide in that manner.

Whatever seed-syllables are present
should be known together with their sounds.

The first, which generates the chief figure,
is to be perfectly completed from HŪṢ,
and all the others should be understood as arising from that.

HŪṢ MĀṢ BHĀ ĀṢ, YĀṢ BHĀṢ ḌĀṢ BHHĀṢa, PRĀṢ MĀṢ SĀṢ ŚĀṢ, PRĀṢ
ŚĀṢ RĀṢ MĀṢ.

The mantras arising from these
are present in full, with light, emerging
from the mouth of the Sugata.
From those, whatever is coarse
must be caused to blaze and radiate without fail.

In the beginning, by means of a single one for all,
from BHĀ arises the variegated —
it is brought into being perfectly.
Beneath that, from KĀ being fully generated,
it is to be contemplated as utterly dry.

Having perfectly completed these, the mantrin,
having fully actualized the body,

I myself accomplish the yoga perfectly.

Then the mantrin endowed with intelligence,
having determined the particular family that applies,
should engage in this method.

The great Lord who pervades, entering into all,
is encompassed everywhere by the chief of the family.

In front is the vajra family,
which without fail destroys asuras and the like.

What abides at the right
belongs to the jewel family,
which without fail destroys flesh-eaters and the like.

What abides behind
fully belongs to the lotus family,
and fulfills whatever is offered — wealth and the like — just as one hopes.

What abides at the left
belongs decidedly to the karma family,
and without fail destroys nāgas, yakṣas, and the like —
all those who are malevolent.

All remaining others besides these
abide without fail in the form of messengers.

When the sun first rises,
the various activities of karma —
each one with its own essence —
are to be recited one hundred and eight times, perfectly complete
from BŪṢ as described above.

Fully endowed with the sound of HŪṢ,
oneself's own mouth blazing brilliantly with fire,
having made the mudrā together with its visualization,
by that very dancing posture in motion,
all malevolent forces are incinerated,
and the Sugata is caused to be supremely delighted.

Taking up the vajra and bell,
by whatever constitutes the wrathful deportment,
the directions are caused to be stupefied.

By assuming the form of a goddess,

the minds of others too are captivated.
Between the half-open eyes,
draw blazing tongues of flame.
Beneath the wheel,
draw without fail the dharmodaya mudrā.
Endowed with skillful means and wisdom,
she is revealed without fail as the Mother who is the origin of all.

Through the proper arising of dependent origination,
ultimate truth depends upon conventional truth,
and conventional truth in turn
genuinely depends upon ultimate truth.

Therefore, since the appearance is not clearly manifest,
the dharmodaya mudrā in particular
is not expansive and the like
but is the wrathful maṇḍala,
and likewise, that which is self-luminous in form —
draw it with mindfulness and attention.

For a person endowed with power,
strength arises with utter certainty.
By accomplishing the two deities of the maṇḍala,
splendor enters into the body.

This is the third chapter, on the maṇḍala and the deity, from the tantra of
Vajra Flame.

Vajrapāṇi, wearing a blue garment,
addressed the Protector of the World with these words:
"Please speak — what is the method
for gladdening the deities of the maṇḍala?"

"Having performed the inner self-purification
and the outer ablution and the like,
and having interrupted the stream of luminosity and the like,
in whatever year is suitable,
beginning from the autumn month of Rā,
the asura planetary lord and the first of the fierce flowers —
upon that very occasion I shall undertake the practice without fail.

Then, first, upon my own body,
I adorn it perfectly with the five ornaments.
On the body, garments that are perfectly blue —
an upper robe and a lower wrap, properly bound.

At the five places — the crown and so forth — one should bind them fully with serpents. Then, seating oneself at the eastern gate of the maṇḍala, one should begin the practice.

First, one canopy — a single one — should be erected above without fail. At each of the four corners, four banners of blue should be suspended all around. From the centers of those canopies, flower garlands threaded on cords should be suspended all around.

Then, abiding in the manner as before, at the places taught above, I shall without fail undertake this activity of mine. Having completed all the ritual activities of the torma (Skt. *baḷi*), the five kinds of offering, and the acacia stake of eight finger-widths, one should perfectly praise them with this mantra:

Oṃ vajrakīlaya sarva-vighnān hana hana hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajrapañcajñāna śodhaya sarva cakṣukāraya hūṃ.

Having recited those mantras twenty-one times over the stake and the five-colored cords, one should properly saturate them fully with the five fragrances — sandalwood and the rest.

Then the mantra-holder endowed with intelligence should begin the wheel of self-protection. At the boundary just outside himself, he should meditate on the cool, unmoving activity. Above that, whatever is the substance that gathers — conceive it as perfectly black in color. From that, the all-pervading one of the fifth family should be properly contemplated. Then, from that completeness, imagining oneself suffused with swirling nectar, and with the vajra-pointing mudrā, one should expel the obstructors by reciting the mantra. At that very apex of the clan-lord, one should contemplate the body-protector arising from the syllable Kaṃ, and imagine it pervading everything by residing at the crown.

Then, with respect to that very torma — the incense offering and whatever accompanies it — in order that karmic obstacles may not arise for beings who have accepted rebirth and been gathered in, one should perfectly accomplish one's intention and make it of value.

Then oneself, with faith, should present the five kinds of offering in one's mind through mantra recitation. From the preceding posture, the right knee being drawn up without fail and the left extended well, holding the vajra itself in the right hand and raising it, then touching its tip to the skull-cup held in the left hand, one places them at the crown; then the skull-cup in the left hand is moved to the right side of the incense, and the right-hand vajra is grasped by the left hand and pressed to the heart. By turning the skull-cup with certainty, one places it definitively at the four directions and corners. From the mouth the sound of Hūṃ blazes forth, and by the dance-method of the multicolored vajra one should circle three times completely.

Then whatever is harmful, having gone to the four directions, the region of ground will surely be purified. Then, by drawing lines and the like, having settled well in preparation and performing the empowerment in due order, one should then determine the dream-omens without fail. Whatever good and bad omens descend, and whatever is to be repelled or not repelled — the one possessed of wisdom should investigate this clearly.

In order to construct the maṇḍala of the buddhas, I first, for the fierce ground, should consecrate five powders with mantras and mudrās. Then the pure vessel skull-cups should be sealed with the performed vajra-mudrā. One should without fail begin the karma yoga practice, and it is to be circumambulated in its direction. Whatever is the substance through which breath flows — with the letter appearing clearly, it should be written in an unbroken stream.

Knowing the right moment at the appropriate instant, one should display a fully wrathful expression. The first is written in black, the second should certainly be opened in white, the third itself is yellow, the fourth possesses full red, the fifth is to be written in green, and the sixth is adorned with various colors.

With the maṇḍala activities completed and fully provided with all material substances, at the four corners — beginning from the northeast corner — earth taken by a maiden, having been fashioned into ritual vases, four blue ones should be placed. At the top of those surrounding them, tying the thread mentioned above, with garlands of blue flowers —

adorned all around. Seventeen blue vases are to be placed without fail in the direction of the outermost boundary, filled well with medicine, incense, essences, rock salt, and tree-resin and the like, and kept there. Adorned

completely with all ornaments, they are placed so as to face toward the body.

Then the wise mantra-practitioner, having precisely applied the counted recitations, is to set out properly: round food offerings without remainder, incense and lamps, anointing fragrances, sacred thread, garlands, swords, and clubs. Parasols, victory banners, and pennants are to be properly placed in the directions without fail.

Then the master himself, having written with saffron dots on blue silk cloth, is to present that very thing as an offering. The surroundings are to be screened off with blue curtains so that those outside cannot see. If it should become visible, everything apart from one's own body will be ruined. Therefore, through careful restraint, it must not be shown to others outside. Remaining alone, one should undertake this performance of the activity. Preceded by the proper prostrations, one devotes oneself to the work of offering. Established in the action-mudrā of the activity itself, with intention made fully manifest, one should clearly examine whatever result will be. Having the complete support of mantras and mudrās, established fully and correctly in the yoga of dispelling hindrances and invoking wisdom, one should make the offering through the mudrā of one's own family while reciting the mantra.

Oṃ namo nīlāṃbara-dhara-vajrapāṇi-maṇḍala-devatānāṃ,
puṣpapūjā-megha-samudra-spharaṇa-samaye hūṃ.

Oṃ namo nīlāṃbara-dhara-vajrapāṇi-maṇḍala-devatānāṃ, dhūpa-niryātayāmi
hūṃ.

Oṃ namo nīlāṃbara-dhara-vajrapāṇi-maṇḍala-devatānāṃ, āloka-niryātayāmi
hūṃ.

Oṃ namo nīlāṃbara-dhara-vajrapāṇi-maṇḍala-devatānāṃ,
gandha-niryātayāmi hūṃ.

Oṃ namo nīlāṃbara-dhara-vajrapāṇi-maṇḍala-devatānāṃ,
naivedya-niryātayāmi hūṃ.

Oṃ namo nīlāṃbara-dhara-vajrapāṇi-maṇḍala-devatānāṃ, śabda-niryātayāmi
hūṃ.

Oṃ namo nīlāṃbara-dhara-vajrapāṇi-maṇḍala-devatānāṃ, caṇiya-niryātayāmi
hūṃ.

Oṃ namo nīlāṃbara-dhara-vajrapāṇi-maṇḍala-devatānāṃ, tari-niryātayāmi
hūṃ.

Oṃ namo nīlāṃbara-dhara-vajrapāṇi-maṇḍala-devatānāṃ,
vāsana-niryātayāmi hūṃ.

Oṃ namo nīlāṃbara-dhara-vajrapāṇi-maṇḍala-devatānāṃ,

gandhāri-niryātayāmi hūṃ.

Oṃ namo nīlāṃbara-dhara-vajrapāṇi-maṇḍala-devatānāṃ, sparśa-niryātayāmi hūṃ.

Oṃ namo nīlāṃbara-dhara-vajrapāṇi-maṇḍala-devatānāṃ, ratna-sarvavastu-niryātayāmi hūṃ.

From that mantra-offering, with the mudrā properly added and with the mantra of confession of misdeeds, one should confess fully and perfectly, bowing in body, speech, and mind with the lamentation-mantra of confession. Then with rejoicing in merit, complete dedication, going for refuge, generating the awakening mind, the four divine abodes, and the very mudrās taught above — all of these are to be understood for the present occasion.

First, arising from the causal state, not remaining in external appearances thereafter, meditate on the luminosity of intrinsic nature clearly shining.

This concludes the fourth chapter, the chapter on offering, from the Tantra of Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Garment with the Vajra-Flame.

Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the Lord of Secrets with these words: "Please speak the inner yoga of fully perfected intention." The Sugata's secret declaration: for one who is to engage in accomplishment —

the accomplishment of the skillful means will be achieved. First, those endowed with wisdom, taking as their starting point what appears to them as a concrete thing, should, in that very state of suchness, with supreme excellence, rightly contemplate the cool-rayed luminosity. Whatever has arisen in that should be contemplated as definitely drawing in the moving breath. From that, the five resplendent families, which have manifestly emerged from the example of emptiness — the beautiful form consorts and the other family consorts — through the transformation of the five immortal ones in time, should be meditated as being offered to the one who holds the apprehension. Then, greatly praised by this mantra, through oneself being endowed with the family, the lord should clearly and definitely make manifest the mudrā:

Oṃ abhiṣiñcatu māṃ vajrapāṇi hūṃ aho āhāraṃ tathā sthito yaṃ aho mama priyaṃ stuti hūṃ.

Resting in oneself upon the concrete thing, not abiding in characteristics, not arisen — primordially established — this is to be contemplated. Through fully engaging with the reality of the buddha, first having contemplated the

concrete things clearly, one should meditate above the form-abode of whatever one is oneself something like an eye-like object. From what has risen above that, one should definitively contemplate the nine types of the awesome ones. Through the application of the eye-like apertures, they appear clearly above the essence. Having accomplished the water above the essence, endowed with a thousand limbs, facing toward the kindred ones and looking upward — from what has arisen above oneself, wrought from two hūṃ syllables, through applying what brings definite clarification above the consort, one enters fully into the essence of the concrete thing. From that, the immortal ones possessed of light, dwelling above the awesome ones, endowed with eight eye-like limbs — apply the eye-like awesome ones as the consort. Skillful means and wisdom are definitively threefold. Having flowed through the three concrete things and dwelling above the essence, one goes definitively above the eye-like. Within the very extent of one's own consort, in the method of sixteen hundred-thousands of moments, completion is fully perfected. At first one should not examine the concrete thing. Since fire blazes at the point of completion itself, that very sequence does not remain, and whatever the appearance of the concrete thing may be — like the tip of a lamp flame — the luminous intrinsic nature shining from without is to be first thoroughly examined. The third stage is fully completed.

Above, two bhaṃ syllables blaze brightly, and the body of the Sage born from hūṃ is to be truly examined. Below as well, it is solely to be generated from the seed of the one above. The two bodhisattvas are definitively settled, and through the proliferation of the wheel, like rain, that which greatly ripens the crops — having abandoned the faults, one abides truly in suchness itself in one's own essential nature. Thus, clearly manifest and unconfused, unstained by faults, it is immaculate. Within space, by the mind that understands all, having fully entered the vajra path, through the various applications of activity of the immaculate jewel and moon, brought into union, one comes to abide in supreme bliss, the non-draining state. The skillful one is made blissful by the bliss of buddhahood. Not viewing the body with attachment, one generates great attachment toward the mind. Gathered fully by such conduct, for one who surpasses nirvāṇa — the supreme, non-abiding nirvāṇa — not abiding in the grounds, and not abiding in anything at all, through the lineage that makes manifest the rank of the vajra of primordial wisdom, with regard to that: why need it be said that the accomplishments of this, whether material and so forth, will certainly be attained? From this activity of those endowed with

wisdom, one should truly accomplish it with great attachment. From the recitation of this very essence of the great blazing fire of the body, one becomes oneself the definitive sign of the fierce secret lotus. It should likewise be practiced continuously. Among the three ritual procedures of mantra recitation, with a particular object definitively visualized, dwelling oneself in an ordinary form, one should contemplate these as mutually passing through one another like a chain of links. With that very fierce recitation and the recitation of the vajra's intrinsic nature —

— is the complete summation of the three families.

Oṃ bho bho vānnāga adhipataye idaṃ nīlāṃbara dhara rīraṃ vajrapāṇi
hṛdayaṃ yasmāt tikramathamākulod sādānāṃ bhaviṣyante tadyathā buddha
buddha vibuddha vibaddha matikramathā hara hara nāgānāṃ prahara
prahara nāgānāṃ chinda chinda nāgaḥṛdayāni bhinda bhinda nāgamarmaṇi
viśīryantunāgaśarīraṃ visphoṭaya nāganāyanāni tadyathā hūṃ phaṭ
nāgavidāraṇāya hūṃ phaṭ nāgakrodhasādanāya hūṃ phaṭ nīlāṃbasanāya
hūṃ phaṭ apratihatavalapārākramāya hūṃ phaṭ kṛtāntāya hūṃ phaṭ
kṛtāntarūpāya hūṃ phaṭ roṣaṇāya hūṃ phaṭ trāsanāya hūṃ phaṭ
kumbhāṇḍodsādanāya phaṭ pretaviśācivināśakarāya hūṃ phaṭ
yakṣāpasmāravināśakarāya phaṭ hana hana hūṃ phaṭ hasa hasa dhara dhara
māraya māraya nāśaya nāśaya sarvavighnāvināśakarāya phaṭ
sarvaśatrūsaṃghavināśakarāya hūṃ phaṭ idaṃ nīlāṃbaradhara
vajrapāṇirājñāpayataṃ svāhā. Oṃ daṃṣṭrakarālodbhīṣaṇanīlāṃbaradhara
vajrapāṇiye nāgālaṃkārasapataketuvyāghracarmaṇibhāsanāya bhama
kāragaruḍarasiti krodhamūrtina trailokyādhāya bhyama mantrāsanaṛūdrāya
nāgacaturmabhakṣāya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ trailokyavijayāya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ
mahākālaroṣaṇāya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vaiśravaṇāya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ amṛtakunḍali
hana hana hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajrayakṣa hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajrayavaitālinī hūṃ phaṭ.
Oṃ vajraḍākāya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ vajrabhairavāya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ
vajraprabhūtapadāya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ manoharāya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ
samantabhadrāya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ śabdagītyai hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ brahmāpatyai
hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ rāgatapriyaṇi hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ māṃsabhakṣiṇe hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ
caṇḍamahāroṣaṇasarvasiddhāya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ maṇidhārivajriṇī hūṃ phaṭ.
Oṃ vāsuratnavitā hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ amṛtasiddhi hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ saṃśodhaya vara
vara hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ capaśasavanirahūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ kumāracaśamaṇi hūṃ phaṭ.

Then, of whatever definitive syllables arise from the ten directions in turmoil, those that are made perfectly clear by the oral instructions of the guru are to be recited in unified form. Whatever enumeration is to be grasped by the

self-arisen mantra practitioner is taught according to the power of the family. Whatever is universally apparent, when gathered into the family, is likewise beyond the ordinary domain even of speech. Through the very essence of the fierce, and through the recitation of the vajra's intrinsic nature, the three families are perfectly subsumed.

In the above mantras, the expert reciter adorns the end of each with hūṃ. At the conclusion of each, the dispersing syllables definitively adorn them, and in this way they are certainly to be recited. For whichever and whatever ritual application is undertaken, the direct higher knowledge of it is correctly taught through the oral instructions specific to each. One who recites with excellence — whether of superior, middling, or lesser capacity — is determined: first in undertaking the approach practice, and finally in entering the activities, fully furnished with count and measure. The domain of practice, being clearly and definitively condensed, is what I am to investigate here. First, attachment to existence; in the middle, whatever abides; and at the end, whatever dissolves — in this way all mantras are elaborately taught. Being fully endowed with the five elements, from them comes the truly abiding ground of all phenomena as they arise. The meaning of the first engagement, which is perfectly conjoined with that, and whatever diverse activities are accomplished from this — these are without exception determined.

This is the fifth chapter, on the inner and mantra sections, from the Tantra of Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Robe, the Vajra Flame.

Then Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Robe spoke thus to the Blessed One, the Protector: "In order to bring sentient beings to ripening —"

"Please teach the method of engagement itself." The omniscient Protector then declared:

"First, the examination of the site and the rest, as was definitively taught above — all the activities are to be brought to perfect completion. In dwellings in a secluded place, the five kinds of cow's products and the like, together with indigo plant and blue bark, are to be properly combined. Apply them perfectly to the full measure of the outermost boundary, and mark it accurately with saffron dots. All the abundant and varied foods, every one of them, dwell completely in sets of five. For the supreme offering-cakes of the excellent activity, the materials are brought together in full abundance.

Arousing the awakening mind, taking refuge, and at the sites of the three secrets — with fragrant dots, together with a vajra, the ritual vase-lady is to

anoint everything, consecrating through these mantras the three immutable ones as the three kāyas:

oṃ tri ma ta bi śo dha ya āḥ hūṃ

Thereupon the tooth-sticks are fully purified by this mantra, given to the disciple for tooth-washing, and then, with the eyes covered and the mind purified, they are to be cast upon the ground. From whatever direction the garland of flowers falls, the attainment (siddhi) of that one is to be declared according to the family to which it corresponds.

Then a blue protective cord, purified by the mantra, is to be bound on the right shoulder of a man and the left shoulder of a woman. With auspicious grass for the strand and the seat, once properly arranged, the signs are to be examined. Together with the favorable and unfavorable omens, what is to be reversed and what does not need to be — one who possesses wisdom examines and acts just as set forth in other tantras.

First, the approach recitation at its superior, middling, and lesser degrees is performed; then, thereafter, the close approach is completed; and after that the wise mantra-practitioner genuinely begins the engagement:

oṃ vajra sa ma ya siddhi ā

oṃ sarva rakṣa sarva siddha āḥ hūṃ

Because the intrinsic nature does not abide as fixed, the defilements of conventional truth are to be purified. Then, from the various gathered provisions, the very maṇḍala spoken of above is to be drawn in full detail. With the materials perfectly assembled and abundant, worship is to be offered as true, complete worship. And, abiding supremely in that very reality in its form, one is truly to generate oneself as that very suchness.

On the lotus itself — the garment and so forth — having wrapped it properly in blue, with the mantra of swirling nectar one sprinkles fragrant water upon it and causes it to enter. Standing definitively in the front, as great and small suchness are brought into proper correspondence, the teacher's fee — one's very own — is caused to be accepted. With the palms joined and held by oneself, the awakening mind and the rest are recited extensively. From the determined diverse appearances, the family is to be identified. With a garland of blue flowers, the mantra is recited and it is cast.

In this way, having fully displayed the assembly of deities, the master himself confers initiation on the disciple with the water of the vase. What is given is

the vase initiation, which is held to purify the coarse.

Thereupon, from the state of bearing the mudrā, through equality grounded in the awakening mind, whatever is fitting — for oneself or for others — is brought to manifest joy and perfectly conjoined with intention. With the mudrā of skillful means and wisdom, it is bestowed upon one's own mouth. These are the secret initiation, and thereafter comes the state of purity.

Then, whatever actual reality one is — a girl of fair complexion and blue in color, moved graciously with the qualities of dance — is properly taken hold of through the rite. Through the movement of the two means, and through the diverse substantial appearances, one then measures four finger-widths below and, pressing upon the two wisdoms, immeasurable bliss is experienced. At the instant of completing that experience, it is taught that one has come to look upon the symbol. Through this, the very initiation of the wisdom of discernment and gnosis is completely and manifestly perfected. Upon the completion of that, the very purity of mind — the fourth, the initiation of the manifest realization of the nature of reality — manifests without needing a separate initiation. Through this one pervades the whole, and what existed in oneself is definitively abandoned:

oṃ ā khi bī ra hūṃ
oṃ ya thā ku la ta thā a haṃ"

The image of all buddhas blazes forth —
right there the student is perfected.

With blue silk and the like,
empowerment is conferred upon the very student,
and through this mantra the blessing is given.

Joining the first two, taking hold of the silk,
one must fasten it properly with the mantra.

A blue, wide-winged garuḍa
with a silk streamer hanging at its throat —
this is to be given definitively to the student,
granting the accomplishment of manifold siddhis (Skt. siddhi, attainments),
subduing all obstructing spirits,
and a blue weapon endowed with a handle,
and also with a garland of blue flowers —
having fastened these to that very one,
the student who holds these mantras and mudrās

is to receive them.

Firmly joining the first and third,
one definitively grasps them upon the crown of the head
and places them on the one who acts.
Counting the left side of the center
by way of the evil-natured joints of one's own body,
binding the joints to the measure of the family-line,
it is set outward upon the one who acts.

What is to be accomplished in the upper part of that:
the great Brahmā (the deity Brahma, lord of the gods) as the one who sees,
and by gathering all offerings,
with red silk or whatever cloth is suitable,
purified by mantra-water and well covered —
whatever objects are to be designated
as definitively one, fourfold:
endowed with the renown that no mudrā can cross,
with the recitation of mantras performed perfectly by a child,
looking wrathfully upon everyone —

oṃ udara saṃghava bhūya hūṃ
oṃ garuḍa sarva nāga bhakṣāya hūṃ
oṃ varaṃ danda ka sarva siddhi prāpta hūṃ
oṃ ājñāpayati loka paśi karāya hūṃ

Then making a fist with that one's hand,
I myself engage in fierce activity;
drawing it out from that fist,
one must give this very essence:

oṃ caṇḍa mahāroṣaṇa vajrapāṇi daha daha sarva vighānāṃ hana hana sarvan
sarva artha śīghraṃ kuru ya hūṃ

Then, regarding the excellent marks and signs:
if one does not abide in lordship over phenomena and so forth,
how could entry ever occur?
In other tantras the general empowerment abides,
and from there entry into all becomes possible.
Without depending on the general empowerment itself,
the supreme reflection upon reality itself —

it is through this alone that entry occurs.

This is the sixth chapter, the chapter on empowerment, from the Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Garment, the Tantra of the Vajra Flame.

Then Vajrapāṇi

addressed the Lord of Secrets (an epithet of Vajrapāṇi as master of esoteric teachings) with these words:

"Please speak the sequential yoga
of the great perfection of all."

The Blessed One, the Sugata, spoke in secret:

Above, and the two upon what is below —
the very nature of the four maṇḍalas
is entirely supreme wisdom.

The essence of the collection: gathering qualities and so forth,
in the forms of seed and fruit —
through emanating and meditating, the downfall is accomplished.

At the pure abode of Vairocana,
possessing the nature of the two root channels,
having descended upon the tip of the lateral lobes,
by reversing that bliss upward,
all becomes unified in the abode.

At the pure abode of Amitābha (Skt. Amitābha, the buddha of Boundless Light),

with sixteen-and-two, wisdom in drawn lines,
upon the awakening drop (Skt. bindu) at the center,
the lateral light-maker is sent down into the abode.

By this, all buddhas are summoned
and become like a wish-fulfilling jewel.

From below, they are gathered into one's own abode.

At the pure abode of Vajrasattva (Skt. Vajrasattva, the primordial bodhisattva of adamantine mind),

possessing the nature of eight-and-four,
by first means of earth and the elements,
one contemplates the definite lines.

From one's own abode, Amitābha is stirred;
one reaches the abode of mingled bliss.

Everything mingles in one's own abode,
endowed with bliss — and through this it is accomplished.

At the emanation abode, among the thirteen,
the second two, properly endowed,
with syllable and drop,
one sends beings out into the abode of bliss.
When they are gathered back, there siddhi arises.
Or else, in the very expanse of the great Middle Way
free from the extremes of eternalism and nihilism,
one sends the subtle gnosis downward.
Reaching the expanse, it then arises below.

At that time, dwelling in non-abiding, free from conceptual thought,
if one is endowed with pure attachment and desire,
one is endowed with the quality of taking up the other.
At the apex, with the mother and the syllable PHAṬ,
the warmth of caṇḍālī arises,
and at the peak one seizes the bodhisattva gnosis.
By that, one draws it back to the emanation abode,
enters into equipoise, and reverses it by means of movement.
The going and coming of the final syllable
is said to be performed with the intention of melting.
From that, purification occurs and siddhi arises.

Or else, the four lower drops
are gathered into the emanation wheel by the wind.
Drawing the awakening mind upward through warmth,
having reached the apex, one contemplates west and north.
Returning and going forth again and again,
finally, upon entering equipoise, accomplishment arises.

Or else, through any of the three groups of four abodes,
one ascends upward,
then turns back and draws it out to the vajra apex,
returns to the abode, and performs the activities.
By this, even the great siddhi
is contemplated as being accomplished like a vajra.
All three realms are purified,

and one will be reborn in pure realms.
When one is endowed with that meditative concentration,
accomplishment in another's domain — abandon that.
Neither abandoning nor taking up,
one rests in the very state of equipoise.

When one's own mind becomes distracted and altered
by form, sound, and so forth,
one contemplates that what is displayed has no inherent nature.
In the intermediate period one contemplates the individual drops,
and examines everything as being like an illusion.
At the very first, in the early times,
one contemplates the qualities of desire as a goddess.
By that, conceptual thoughts are pacified.

This is the seventh chapter, the chapter on the yoga of the Great Perfection
stage of all activities, from the tantra Vajrapāṇi (Vajra-in-hand) of the
Blue-Clad One with the Vajra Flame.

Then Vajrapāṇi
addressed the Blessed One, the Protector, with these words:

"For the benefit of all the world,
please speak on the sequence of torma."

The omniscient Protector declared:

"For the benefit of the yogins,
I shall explain the torma.

Benefiting and cutting off —
these are the supreme benefit and the ordinary.
The secret is held to be the supreme and unsurpassed.
One should know the outer, inner, and ordinary.
Extensive, condensed, and extremely condensed —
cutting off also should be known.

Summoning, expelling, slaying,
suppressing, and burning — these one should know.

The continuous, the great occasion, and the triple,
and the small continuous or the great occasion:
twelve, four, or finally one.
Five roots or five branches.

Grains, fruits, medicines,
and corresponding substances such as protuberances and the like —
upon these, the three whites are auspicious for nāgas.
Blood nose, heart nose, three kinds of flesh nose —
these and similar concordant substances for cutting off.

Endowed with the generation stage,
having been protected from above,
performing the rite three times,
or else instantly generating as a deity,
filling with all the substances an endowed lotus
bearing the characteristic marks,
marked with the moon, vajra, and HŪṂ —
at the height of a cubit, bearing the hare mark.
It is marked with the sixteenth part, the seventh mark.
Endowed with the vajra mark,
it gathers and moves, radiating blue, red, and white.
The lotus light has the three of the five wisdoms.
Triangular below, bearing a crescent moon.
From the dark-blue radiance of the heart,
the vajra navel is aroused, the three extremities set in motion.
Blazing red, endowed with marks, it unfolds.
Gathered by mind and refined by speech,
the mountainous light radiating from the body is aroused.
From the wisdom-endowed one, rays of light radiate.
By that, the father and mother are aroused,
and the white-colored ambrosia descends.
The first, that which arouses, dissolves into light.
It flows down to the lotus through the interior channel.
Upon the heel of what has descended, that very suchness falls.
Circling three times, as the lower one,
it is marked at the first and second of the fourth.
Then the seat is generated and the retinue with it is summoned.
With DZIM, the vajra, and the interior channel,
contemplate the first and second of the fourth.
Or else, having contemplated briefly as a deity,
at the heart, a sun, above it HŪṂ —

from the light a triangular dharmodaya is emanated.
Within it, a lotus,
eight-petalled, charnel-ground, in its center —
from YAM wind arises, from RĀM fire,
above that, from A, a skull-cup,
within it ambrosia, OM ĀḤ HŪM,
above that, the moon, vajra, HŪM.

From the moon, AM radiates light, drawing in the ambrosia.
Contemplate it as gathered, melted, and transformed into ambrosia.
In sequence with the three syllables,
light radiates from the heart and strikes the wind.
The wind fans the fire, which boils the skull-cup.
Through that condition, it is gathered,
gathered at the tip of the bow and the spear,
then combined with the three syllables and offered.

Alternatively, with a white goddess,
fill what bears the marks and make offering.
Or else, generating oneself as a deity in an instant,
with the HŪM at the heart, purify the ambrosia.
Then again, the wisdom ambrosia descends.
For a moment, through an emanation, the deity partakes of it.
Having praised, the deity departs and the task is entrusted.

Elaborate, condensed, and extremely condensed:
the practice of food-offering accords with the condensed form.
Thus purification is performed with the hundred-syllable mantra.

This is the eighth chapter, the ritual chapter on the torma offering, from the
Vajra of Blue Garments, the Tantra of the Vajra Flame, whose holder is
Vajrapāṇi.

Then Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Garments
spoke these words to the Blessed One, the Protector:
"For the auspiciousness of all yogins
and the dispelling of all harm,
please teach the fire-offering ritual."

The Protector of the World declared:
"For those who cultivate recollection,

and those who desire to obtain siddhi,
and for the purpose of bringing to mind the instructions in sequence,
this will be explained for the benefit of the yogins.

Having first performed the approach practice,
at the time of the accomplishment practice,
all activities are fulfilled through the fire offering.

Examine, raise, and purify the site;
consecrate and protect it.

The ground, which is white, shall be one cubit square,
and twelve finger-widths in circumference, made round.

In the center, a five-pronged vajra,
made to be eight finger-widths across.

The hearth shall have five features of that form,
and within, smear everything with white fragrant substance.

Scatter white flowers appropriate to the three times.

Wood of the neem tree and the palāśa,
of the udumbara and the mango,
and so on — trees of awakening,
those bearing leaves, those bearing milk,
cut them equally, fresh and moist.

From the tip-portions, to the measure of a hand-span,
smeared with milk, butter, honey, and so forth —
those with two branch-tips, with leaves, are to be offered.
Those that are old, rotted, split, or eaten by insects,
and those where living creatures dwell, are to be avoided.

Barley, mung beans, sesame,
large rice, mustard, butter, and yogurt,
flowers, hot water, and fragrant substances —
offer whatever is available.

As for the form of the fire-wood:
it shall be slightly shorter than the hearth
and made fatty like the wool of a hermitage.

Then the mantra-practitioner, having bathed the body,
is smeared with fragrant incense and saffron,
bearing the mind of the four immeasurables,

dressed in white with the ornaments of peace.
Having clearly visualized the yoga of the deity,
in the evening and in the early morning hours,
facing east,
perform the pacification with a mind of peace.

Anoint with fragrant water containing offerings and grain,
recite the essence mantra of one's own deity,
and with the water of all activities
purify with the mantra of Vajra Yakṣa.

All the implements of the activities — the vase
and the offering-water vessel — are to be placed on the left.
The fire-wood and the offering substances are placed on the right.

Then, with "OM VAJRA YAKṢA HŪṢ,"
the fire is lit.

The fire is fanned with a bellows.

"OM JVALA JVALA HŪṢ" —
that is the heart mantra for kindling the fire.

Then, with HŪṢ, generate the hearth.
In its center, from RĀṢ, a triangular fire.

Resting upon a lotus, from OM,
the fire-deity arisen from RĀṢ:
white in body, adorned with ornaments,
excellently adorned with a garland of flames,
with a broad belly, garland hanging on the left,
the vajra-fire holding a water-pot.

Endowed with the yoga of one's own deity,
from the light-rays of the seed syllable at the heart,
the wisdom being of the fire-deity is drawn in.
It is drawn in and brought under command.

Then empowerment is bestowed
and the body, speech, and mind are blessed.

Then, having offered the water of offering,
full worship is performed with the five offerings.

Worship with the offerings beginning with the beautiful goddess and the rest.

"OM AGNAYE HAVYAKAVAHĀṆĀYE HAVYATĪYĀṆĀYE SVĀHĀ" —
with this, the offering substances are to be presented.

Then the sequence of presentation:
into the blazing fire, the wood —

Then butter, and after that sesame,
then rice and the rest in sequence.

Then praise is offered and the task is entrusted.

Then, within the fire, one is to visualize and confer empowerment upon oneself
in the form of one's own supreme deity, step by step,
and bless body, speech, and mind.

Then too, water of offering and foot-water are presented,
the five pure offerings are made,
and the beautiful goddess and the rest are offered.

Then Vajrapāṇi: with a blue garment imagined at his tongue
and HŪṂ held in mind,

"OM CAṆḌA MAHĀROṢAṆA HŪṂ PHAṬ ŚĀNTIṂ KURU SVĀHĀ" —
the sequence is to be carried out as before.

For each offering substance, seven by seven,
or alternatively three by three, are to be presented.

At the conclusion of the recitation it is essential to perform the fire offering.
For that, an offering of butter is made,
or alternatively purified linseed,
or mustard seed mixed with butter is offered.
With fresh butter, mustard seed, and the like,
the karmic obscurations are purified.

Therefore, twenty-one times,
or alternatively one hundred and eight times, they are offered.

Then water of offering and aspersion water are presented, and praise is
performed.

"OM — from the distinguishing quality of great primordial wisdom,
the emanation is Vajrapāṇi:
a body like deep blue, blazing with rays of light,
a face fierce and wrathful, magnificent, subduing māras,
the right hand holding a five-pointed vajra,

the left hand resting on the hip, a bell swaying there,
the body adorned with ornaments and fine garments,
encircled by an assembly of tens of millions of attendants —
to him I offer praise and homage."

Then again the fire deity is worshipped and praised as before.

For the wrathful maṇḍala — triangular in shape,
half a cubit in depth, dug into the earth —
the three southern corners are pointed outward,
and the nectar and the rest are made black.

In its center, cleared upon a vajra,
a mountain of fire rises to a peak in the middle.

The firewood is dark, wood that is harmful,
the height of a cubit or so above the hearth's measure,
wide and proportionate — twelve cubits across.

The offering substances are black, and only those.

The burning substances: black butter, bone, blood, flesh,
life-wood, gibbet-wood, mustard seed,
and the like — substances of power —

and for these substances, effigies are to be made.

The offering substances are placed on the right, the burning substances on the left;

they are to be consecrated and arranged.

Ladle for filling and pouring ladle accord with the other rites,
or alternatively they may be done by hand.

These two, together with the vajra and bell,
are to be placed directly in front.

Everything is purified with the karma vase.

The time is to be midnight or midday.

One dresses in black, wears ornaments, faces south,
sits with the left leg extended, and recites intensely.

The teeth are bared and the brows are drawn together in a wrathful frown.

If one has previously performed the approach practice in advance,
one examines the fire-omen and repels obstructors.

If it is auspicious, this need not be done.

The hearth is purified and the generation is performed,
and through three ritual sequences, or in a single instant,
the wrathful black fire deity is generated.
The wisdom being is invited and merged.
Having sealed the two as non-dual,
the mantra of the fire deity is charged with the offerings and presented.

Then the burning substances are to be offered.
The esoteric instruction for offering them is this:
through the wrathful one's own magical display,
the effigy is summoned, merged, and stabbed, then offered —
or alternatively, through the power of the supreme substances bringing
delight,
the wrathful one's light-rays summon and burn.
Diligent attention must be given to this esoteric instruction.

"OMṬ VAJRA KRODHA AGNAYE CHE GE MO MĀRAYA PHAṬ" —
one thousand times, or one hundred times, or twenty-one times.
Or else, in accordance with the gradation of one's merit,
one hundred, one thousand, or ten thousand times.

Having done it thus, all activities are accomplished.
Finally, the vessel is filled, libation is poured, and praise is offered.

Then in his heart, a blue garment is generated,
the wisdom being is invited and merged,
the seal is pressed, and offerings are made as before.
Then the burning mantra is offered as before:

"OMṬ VAJRA KRODHĀ NĪLĀMBARADHARA VAJRAPĀṆĪ RĀJÑĀPAYATI CHE GE MO
MĀRAYA HŪṬ PHAṬ" —

the esoteric instruction above is to be known and applied.
The vessel is filled, libation is poured, and praise is performed.

"From the palace of Laṅkā of the willows,
the Lord of Secrets, wearing blue garments,
the emanator of all buddhas —
to you, supreme in conferring empowerment, I bow and offer praise.

With a form that is fierce, wrathful, and magnificent,
the one who performs all diverse activities,
unobstructed, in the manner of a wish-fulfilling jewel —

to the vajra body I bow and offer praise."

Though all things are utterly pure,
the speech that arises through the power of aspiration,
the manifold sounds free from words —
to you, vajra jewel, I bow and offer praise.

Glorious one, wearing blue garments,
holding in hand a blazing wheel,
taming the gods through skillful means —
to you, king of gods, I bow and offer praise.

Glorious great one, wearing blue garments,
holding in hand a blazing garuda bird,
taming the nāgas through skillful means —
to you, tamer of nāgas in blue garments, I bow and offer praise.

Glorious great one, wearing blue garments,
holding in hand a blazing club,
performing the taming of all yakṣas —
to you, chief of yakṣas, I bow and offer praise.

In order to tame what has become fierce and wrathful,
light blazes from the tip of the threatening finger,
subduing utterly all that is harmful —
to you, unobstructed vajra, I bow and offer praise.

Having entrusted the activities, request the departure.
Gather the samādhi and refresh the view.
Having assembled all the substances,
offer them to the fire deity and praise him.

Fill what is incomplete with the hundred-syllable mantra.
Gather the samādhi and perform the conduct.

This concludes the ninth chapter, the chapter on the fire offering rite, from the Tantra of the Vajra Flame of Vajrapāṇi in Blue Garments.

Vajrapāṇi in Blue Garments then made this petition to the Blessed One, the protector: "For those who have been seized by nāgas, what is the method? Please speak." The omniscient Lord declared: "Relying upon this very practice of mine, tame the nāgas. On a level and even piece of ground in the western direction, dig a pit of a size such that a foot can enter. Above it, place a girl

who previously performed the twelve-feast rite — one of noble lineage and blue complexion, or one fully endowed with the four lineages — anoint her with milk, apply the drop upon her, clothe her in clean red garments, and offer her complete praise. With the five ornaments adorned upon her, attach a vessel below her feet and a vessel of authority below her hands. She, remaining properly in place, makes the mudrā. Whatever is the name of the nāga, apply it properly to the substance. Then, with the supreme lord who is the origin of all, surround it with the eight retinue members and establish it firmly. In the west, place the supporting substances at the four corners. Accomplish the practice in that very place as best one can. Having properly attained it, separated entirely, without looking in that direction, recite the mantra of great ferocity. Upon seeing that very result, recite a verse expressing delight. Then, in a location properly secluded, perform the practice well. The width shall be fixed at one cubit, and the height shall be made to measure half a cubit. Having fully applied raṃs and blue bark, perfumed water, and the like, and having anointed it completely with the five kinds of cow products, make a variegated lotus of sixteen petals with a full pericarp and fully open petals. Above it, place small water-born lotuses arranged in the directions. Above those, arrange in form the assemblies of deities. On the outside, encircle it properly with a blazing garland. Previously, whatever was encircled by the outstretched finger, grind it smooth and completely round from all sides with red color. Upon that, the six classes of nāgas — fish, frogs, female nāgas, snakes, cranes, crocodiles, humans, frogs, oxen, cats, jewel-cobras, and great serpents — having been seized by the portion of the lord, are drawn out forcefully behind. With flour of the citron, fill the four corners. The corresponding substances are to be made perfectly clear. At night, for the fierce torma, fix it precisely as the fourth appearance. With the blazing recitation of the mantra, holding the fierce garland, having erected a blue tent, as long as this has not been completed, I shall not look, but recite intensely in ferocity itself. For those outer stages of this, with various and abundant great trees, and with a blue cord while reciting the mantra —

draw it fully connected in a net. For the outer stages, let it be completely encircled with fierce thorns. With the five kinds of offerings, make offerings without fail at both times of day. Recite the complete essence-mantra together with the fierce mantra of Garuḍa. On top, cover it properly with fierce thorns. At the periphery, let all the assembled gods recite the essence-mantra one hundred and eight times over everything until it is absorbed. Below that, with

a precisely fixed count — for the best, middling, and least practitioners — assigning the mantra and mudrā correctly in the mode of dress befitting oneself as the principal deity: when the recitation count is complete, summon the patient there and have them remain in the northern direction.

Into a silver basin, fill it completely with white seeds of the heart. With the sixteenth part bearing the sound of fullness, cut twelve finger-lengths of iron-dry kābīja wood, and recite the mantra over them explicitly, purifying them right there. Having greatly praised the peacock's spine, bind the wood together with the spine correctly using lotus-fiber cord. A sengdeng-wood kīla of twelve finger-lengths, consecrated explicitly with the wrathful mantra: then, having fully consecrated it with the mantra, apply it to the patient and fix it precisely at the six classes of beings. Then upon that very one's heart, write exactly six bindus. Having visualized the six classes above that, the supreme pride abiding on the left, impelled explicitly by the mantra, departs with fierce force and is struck precisely into the gaping mouth of the terrifying one. Having thus firmly resolved the intention, one should meditate fully. The harmer who harms that one will not remain even for a moment, but will quickly flee in fear in all ten directions.

Oṃ vajra krodha amṛta kuṇḍali nī dāta yaṃ prati hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ bandha bandha nāgānāṃ phaṭ. Oṃ garuḍa garuḍa putra bhakṣa nāgānāṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ nīlāṃ vasana sarva alaṃkṛtva me vajrapāṇi bhavate hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ bhekṣa magalen sarva vyādhi petaya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ bhakṣi ce viśanāya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ sarva nāgānāṃ ākarṣaya viśaya vitoṣaya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ mahāraudra garuḍa gaccha grhṇa grhṇa sarva nāgānāṃ phaṭ.

With whatever kīla was described above, striking with the recitation of this mantra:

Oṃ vajrakīlāya sarva nāga vidhvaṃsana hūṃ phaṭ.

With the face blazing fiercely and with the meditative absorption of vajra-aversion, strike completely with the sound of thunder. Then with the fierce mantra, fix the mark without fail. Whatever arises right there — let one possessed of wisdom examine it. Whatever bears the sign: the bodies trembling, and whatever has caused the forms to shake — that is established as the definitive sign. Whatever trembling occurs in that itself — that too is established as a definitive sign.

At the first arrival, by clearing away the inner obstructing spirits, the outer disease is cleared from outside. Through compounds of medicines and the like,

the wise one clears the outer disease: prescribe specifically bragha and the other five, along with black butter, and by applying pressure for a period of seven days, small blisters will appear spreading well. Combined with suṇpa and other applications, before that remain in the mantra retreat. Having bathed in the sun, understanding it completely as white light, impurity is considered to be cleansed. Stimulate the six purifications without fail.

After that, whatever is the supreme medicine — one tola of the greatly renowned one — when properly boiled, it will form a paste right at the mouth. Apply this to the body, and eat three portions of yogurt with it. Directed toward the three essence-mantras in the east, the fluid is to be drunk without fail. A dark-blue triangular feather with an extremely sharp tip, on which various markings will appear — fully gathering one hundred of these, boil them precisely into a sixteenth part.

Apply that to the body, and from the mouth it is to be drunk without fail. By this, everything will be purged, and illness will certainly be expelled.

Combine various fragrant scents into ale, and let it ferment for exactly ten days without fail. Then, once it has turned blue, add a full palmful of salt, and steep it. After four days of steeping, on the fourteenth day, mix in the leaves themselves along with phul-do, and boil it until the foam clears completely. When applied to the body, draw six mouthfuls from it without fail. If one relies steadily on this preparation, one will live without fail, free from spirit affliction.

This concludes the tenth chapter from the tantra of Vajrapāṇi (the vajra-bearing one, clad in blue) with the vajra-flame — the chapter on subduing the affliction of the poisonous nāga that steals one's radiance.

Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the world-protector with these words: "For one who has been seized by Brahmā, please teach: what is the method?"

The supreme protector declared: "What is called the Brahmā demon-affliction is exceedingly difficult to tame. Unless one acts with force against it, ordinary beings cannot get rid of it. A brahmin mantrin of unbearable power, or one who wields the sound of ferocity — when fourteen nighttime feast-offerings have been performed, for three days the three white foods are to be offered continuously without interruption. Being endowed with the Vedic mantra himself, he is the one to be trained in this. He binds the upper body with Brahmā's thread and adorns himself completely with pure white garments. He ties a topknot at the crown of his head, and with his right four — that very hand — he fully bears the auspicious substances. Going to the east, from a

great tree, at a cubit from the root below, he takes the soil by digging. Holding the basis — white cloth — without looking to the sides, he recites the essence-mantra of the wrathful one toward the east. Then, upon seeing it, he also utters the sound 'hala hala.' All five varieties of bile, combined with the ramos plant, indigo bark, and fragrant water — with these, he is to make a maṇḍala of one cubit in length and one cubit in height, endowed with five corners. At the very center of the maṇḍala, he is to place the assembly of deities without fail. At the five corners and adjoining petals, with a triangle of eight finger-widths, he is to engrave all around deeply. Below, powdered medicine is to be spread out well. Having made an image of that very one from monkey fat, a measure of ten fingers — once the fierce one has become still — he is to raise both hands to the ground. With a barberry stake of four finger-widths, he is to encircle it all around at the edge. Also above, he is to press in mustard-seed stakes completely while reciting the mantra. He is to make tormā offerings that generate power, and with the five offerings, at both times he is to make offerings correctly. Remaining in his former manner himself, taking up the rosary with confidence, he is to recite the root mantra of the wrathful class to the full measure. Then all the subsidiary essence-mantras, one hundred and eight of them, are to be recited. After those, the one to be recited next is its life-essence-mantra — that is to be recited without fail. Removing barberry thorns, he is to remain at the edge of the maṇḍala. Then he recites the summoning mantra, and having caused it to dissolve fully to the measure, if that very one has not come, with the smoke of black bdellium resin, he invokes it and recites the summoning mantra openly, and with the mudrā of the iron hook he is to draw it fully forth. Then the mantrin, having openly summoned the patient before him, is to sprinkle him without fail with mantra-water. Then, when the one to be accomplished arrives, that image will either transform or will fall over. After that, I will apply words of truth and pacification. If it has departed, I am being of lesser heart. But if it will not go, I shall undertake this preparation. To a cord endowed with five strands, having thoroughly praised it with the wrathful mantra, one binds the patient with a tight noose, draws it by the hook from the heart, and taking the vajra in the left hand —

With the right hand, having seized it with confidence, let the mantra-practitioner recite the full assembly of mantras with body, speech, and mind at their most fierce. Having bound with the five mudrās, let those same five be fully drawn down. Then, into a bundle of khyer-pa wood, having

inserted it with guggul-water, one burns it for the purpose of destruction. With poison, kīla, saffron, fine-colored white mustard, and vātī-water, one is to recite mantras throughout and burn it. Through the blazing of that very speech as one's own essence, one makes true offering to the wheel. Then with a black iron tent, one is to cover it for the sake of secrecy.

Oṃ bhūr bhuṭa sābuvas svāhā. Samana ākāse me kartaṃ. Bhuyu bhūta brahma ni kaya yaṃ sara para bhūta svāhā. Oṃ tili tila vajra śara śavara hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ brahmarakṣa ghaya hṛdaya kara dicchediya phaṭ. Oṃ ākarṣaya ākarṣaya gataya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ amṛtasiddha hara hara viśodhaya baṃ hūṃ. Oṃ bandhanāṃ duṣagaya hūṃ. Oṃ vajrakṣobha hūṃ. Oṃ tārakṣobha hūṃ. Oṃ atrakṣobha hūṃ. Oṃ brahma akṣagrahāya. Dahaya mārāya chindaya avicārāya bhausaṭ he phaṭ phaṭ.

Burned by that burning, my body and speech — with words of remorse toward that one who has been scorched — I shall speak with certainty. By that very means, that same body and all the rest, together with the spirit-affliction, will be freed and will become pacified. Then, having anointed the patient's body with ash, one is to affix the protective wheel in the following manner.

As for blue thread, let it be that of a girl who is wealthy, of good family, beautiful, and eighteen years of age. Between the two successive windings of it, by having it coiled, there will be no affliction. Having extracted it from among the dust, having taken it up — improperly handled by the gods — one is to affix it to a body at ease, with certainty. By means of this, throughout all lives, the protection will abide well.

Prepare fully a fine victory-vase of the three realms, blazing and triumphant. With mantras it is to be fully adorned. With kīla, vajra-lasso, and hammer, empowerments are to be conferred in sequence. Then, with the five offerings, one performs extensive offering to the body. Whatever has been perfectly accomplished is praised with mudrā. To the buddhas, bodhisattvas, lamas, and vajra-holders, one reverently offers buddhic bliss in fully expanded offering. Preceded by drawing near, one accomplishes fully. The method of accomplishment in relation to the wrathful one who is victorious over the three realms has been correctly explained.

As for that same preparation described above, one goes to a charnel ground and smears one's own body thoroughly with human ash. Taking a skull in the left hand and a vajra in the right, one recites the fierce mantras many times on a white confidence-rosary. One partakes of good things belonging to that one,

wraps the lower body in tiger-skin, and meditates on the essence endowed with meaning. Having also smeared the face with blood, one enters into the names of the eight dark-class transferrers and meditates upon the stars with certainty. Having established a place at the gathering of beer, endowed with the paired wisdom, one unites with the stars themselves and recites mantras through the lineage transmission. For one hundred and eight days one is to accomplish correctly. Thereafter, let the days dissolve. At the end, on the very night at close range, one is to recite the mantras with certainty.

Then, having dissolved one thousand fire-offerings with saffron, white mustard, blood, and honey combined, and anointing a karavīra switch with white sandalwood-water, then having tied a garland of flowers to it and taken it in the right hand — having placed it correctly on the hairs of confidence by means of a cord, and having bound it to the crown of one's own head — when one then wanders through the city, everyone will bow down and make offering.

All the world bows before that one and holds them dear in their hearts without doubt. Ḍākinīs and other subtle feminine spirits will certainly bestow scriptural transmissions upon that one. Suffering will not arise constantly, and though asuras (demigods) and other malevolent beings see that one as a target for harm, and though many wrongs are directed at that one, no fear is to be generated toward them. Even when many harmful and diverse things cause various injuries, no fear is to be aroused, and they are to be offered worship with a joyful mind.

Om kapāladhara siddhaye. Om bhakṣa sarva namaḥ sānāṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ. Om ḍākinya vaśīkarāya svāhā. Om sarvalokā vaśīkarāye hūṃ. Om sarvaduṣṭa citta sanaya phaṭ. Om mahākāla sabaya hūṃ phaṭ.

This is the eleventh chapter, on subduing the demonic affliction of the brahmin demon, from the Vajrapāṇi Blue-Robed One's Vajra Flame Tantra.

Then Vajrapāṇi, the Blue-Robed One, addressed the Blessed Protector in these words: For one who has been seized by Yama, the Lord of Death, what method is to be employed?

The King of Reasoning declared: The demon called Yama's Red Chamber — dark blue in color, possessed of four fangs, holding a skull-staff in the right hand and a human head in the left hand — this is a fierce and terrifying demon. For those who have been seized by it, this method is to be correctly applied.

Having gathered twenty persons with fierce voices, extremely brave and endowed with faith, powerful and of a wrathful nature, one is to perform the approach practice for six days. One presents the five meats and the like along with liquor, and having struck those with mantras, one fully clothes the image in a variegated flesh-garment and adorns it with beautiful flowers. Then one recites this very mantra one hundred thousand times. After that, to the right of that figure one is to make a definite offering of a lasso, reciting the heart-dhāraṇī "Ghasa ghasa." On the left, one pierces a thing with a great wish-fulfilling hook, pressing it firmly down. Then, in the third astrological portion belonging to the dark class, one is to invoke the constellation and take up the level ground. Having obtained that ground, the wise mantra-practitioner is to construct the maṇḍala precisely — six-sided, measuring one cubit and a span, four finger-breadths in height, laid out properly. It is to be smeared with five substances: indigo plant, blue dye, and the five kinds of excrement. One draws sixteen wheels correctly, and around the border it is to be surrounded diversely with a blazing garland. Upon it the divine assembly is to be properly arranged, and one canopies it entirely with a blue upper cloth. At that same maṇḍala, in the petal-joined wheel, one is to excavate a round pit, scooping out a full cubit. Below, it is to be made firm with poison powder, correctly compacted. Around the rim one is to arrange a border of weapons such as knives and the like. Above it one pitches a canopy of cloth, and the heart-dhāraṇī of the Great Black One is to be fully recited one hundred thousand times. Remaining in one's own prior manner, holding a rosary of bones in both hands, one grasps it in the wrathful lineage-fashion and recites the root mantra and others so that they dissolve in. The five kinds of offerings and the torma (ritual cake) consisting of great meat and the like are to be presented in pairs and dispatched as offerings. With the invocation dhāraṇī itself, one is to draw that being in properly. With a blazing sword, one is to take up a definite position in the eastern direction. There, one is to recite fully the mantra of the Great Black One. That being's life-heart-syllable is applied at the border and recited correctly. After that, a figure of that being — sixteen finger-breadths on a torma base — is made in a terrifying form and anointed with indigo. Inside it, that being's name is to be written out clearly and then inserted inside. An iron thorn, its tip anointed with poison, is to have poison inserted all around it toward that being's quarter. Consecrating it with mantras, one is to firmly bind a cloth over its top. In this manner, through completion of the approach practice over thirty days, with the sick person's

garment and so forth —

— together with the garments and so forth belonging to oneself and the others — are all gathered into a vessel, thoroughly praised with the great mantra. Then, upon completion of the approach practice, the sick person's personal effects are summoned, and with palms fully joined, the awakening mind is generated and refuge is taken.

With a blazing vajra hook, one draws out the spirit from its heart, and the sound of om vajra phaṭ is loudly proclaimed. Through the meditative absorption of the vajra of aversion, in the form of a wrathful deity and with a fierce cry, a rosary is held in the right hand and a blazing sword is grasped in the left. One is to contemplate Mahākāla — the Great Black One — suddenly erupting, annihilating that being's aggregates.

Then the wise mantrin is to pierce the effigy with a weapon. Thereafter, having drawn it outside, the neck is to be thoroughly cut with whatever sword is at hand. By thus reciting mantras and cutting, the sick person will emit a strangled cry. As a sign that it is fully accomplished, the gods stir in every direction, and the effigy itself trembles — this trembling of the effigy is shown as the sign of accomplishment. Whatever pieces there are, one tosses a torma mixed with the others. Through this method of application, liberation from the spirit of Yama (the Lord of Death) is certain. Having been liberated from it, one must definitely proceed to draw a protective wheel.

A cord of five colours is boiled in a decoction of nutmeg leaves, mantra of the blazing vajra is inserted into it, twenty-one knots are tied, and it is to be fastened around that one's neck. This is the supreme protection; thereafter, outer obstacles will not enter.

Om phara phara ya ta hūṃ svāhā. Om kaṃ kaśari bhava pa phaṭ. Om ghasa ghasa varūpa haya haya saṃca hūṃ. Om mahākāla yaṃ gha hamāraya hūṃ phaṭ. Om ākarṣaya ākarṣaya sarva maya na hūṃ. Om yamadu duhe da ana asarva yamena ha. Om śatatīkṣṇarūpena yama cchinda cchindanāṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Yaṃ om caṇḍakhad geda yama cchindakarāya phaṭ. Om jvala jvala narogi rakṣa rakṣa svāhā.

When spirits are thus definitively dispelled, in order to slay whatever things are harmful to the yogin, one is to accomplish this Great Black One. It must be examined extremely carefully and pursued directly — it is not to be applied for trifling matters. When the Dharma is directly imperilled and so forth, one undertakes the application with great compassion.

First, in a great temple, or a great stūpa, or a supremely renowned and excellent charnel ground, one is to paint a fine image of the Great Black One oneself, and for seven days offer varied and plentiful offerings, burning the incense of the five bright substances and the incense of the five immortal substances.

For the initial and primary matter, from among those whose skin is certified as trustworthy, one is to write accurately whatever comes from it. Then, at whatever place it may be, under the stars one performs complete worship — the five bright substances and the five immortal ones, along with further various bright substances — and worships properly.

With the varied heroes and whatever varied offerings are at hand, one worships for three months. One transforms one's own dress and anoints the body with blood. Whatever destructive substance there is, in the maṇḍala of blazing fire in all directions, by summoning the two upper syllables, one engraves it fully.

Into it one pours accurately whatever substance is needed, mixes it thoroughly with skull-fat, putrid flesh, and sinew — those three combined — and whatever person is to be targeted, visualising them clearly there, knowing how to apply mantra and mudrā, one makes the offering with clear visualisation.

Into the torma itself, various substances being poured in, it is fully dispatched at midnight. From that very heart-centre, mind and mentation unified are properly contemplated. Whatever of the upper portion of this remains, whatever things that remain unchanging are contemplated — those two, white and black, are what are related to this. On that very black substance —

Whatever white substance there is, one generates force and causes it to remain clearly. Thus, by means of many instants, having caused it to fully abide, one arouses in oneself fierce pride. One should think that from its arising, accomplishment is achieved. By means of what serves as the sign, that very substance stirs, a fierce sound too is heard, and the terrifying form of an unruly sentient being appears directly and manifestly — then accomplishment is certain. That which achieves this accomplishment, the object to be accomplished — those very three are to be burned. Having fashioned the shape of a half-skull bowl, one places the life-heart at its centre. Then one addresses the Great Black One with words of blamelessness, directed to the Great Black One himself, and by reciting his mantras — the five of supreme clarity and the five of immortality, and all of the heroes and so

forth — those very three combined, along with the substance and so forth, are to be completely pierced with a blade. Then, with fire properly applied, fully endowed with mantra and mudrā, through fierce body, speech, and mind, one unfailingly performs the application of the action.

Oṃ mahākāla mārāya mārāya sarva śatrūṇāṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ. Oṃ mahākāla sarva śatrū chindaya phaṭ. Da sa daṃ re pha ra ha ha ha bha svāhā.

Then the mantra-practitioner, possessing complete understanding, whatever person commits harm against buddhas, bodhisattvas, śrāvakas, and pratyekabuddhas — that person engaged in yogic practice — one applies correctly with the mind of a superior. Regarding that, through the guru's oral instructions one should properly distinguish. By making offerings to the guru himself to the best of one's ability, one draws out the oral instructions. Since accomplishment is certain through this, carry it out completely with full confidence.

This is the twelfth chapter, concerning the subjugation of the possession of the red-faced lord of death, from the Tantra of the Vajra Flame, the Blue-Robed Vajrapāṇi.

Vajrapāṇi of the blue robe addressed the Blessed One, the Protector, in these words: Whatever one is seized by the possession of yakṣas, please speak the two methods for that. The Protector of Secrets declared: From the possession known as yellow-faced yakṣa, which has become extremely fierce, this method should be properly composed. A form of thirty yellow complexions, endowed with a fierce voice, possessed of power and utterly reverent — for food, honey mixed with sesame is given, and one certainly propitiates for seven days. Having adorned pure garments of green and praised them with these mantras: "I, with perfect joy, make offering to the buddhas as an offering" — then to the thirty, one makes the substance support. Having saturated cloth of cotton and the like with the thing, one goes to an empty building to the north, and from the ground itself one takes it up. Praised well by the base-bodied son, one also recites the essence, and having obtained that, one recites the mantra of the fierce one of the north without looking back. Then the wise mantra-practitioner makes a maṇḍala of one and a half cubits, fashioned in four corners, with indigo dye, blue-black skin, pepper, and the five fragrant things of cattle — the height precisely two finger-breadths. Having made the inside perfectly round, seventeen dots of white sandalwood are to be written. Above that, the assembly of deities of the wheel abides. A canopy of green is raised. Then in

that very associated petal-arrangement, in the square maṇḍala itself, one carves precisely at twelve fingers' width across and a half-skull depth. Mixed with cuckoo poison, one smears it in its bed. The five offerings and the torma, and the white substances of the ritual application and so forth, are all to be dispatched completely. Having made a rosary from the bones of one who died with a great cry, grasping that very thing of fierce type, one recites the blazing root mantra and others. As those dissolve above, reciting the mantra of the base-bodied son, that too — at the very measure of the superior — having proceeded, one recites it completely. A wish-fulfilling phurbu of ten fingers, sixteen of them, of that very —

one is to turn it completely at the mouth. Oneself, in the earlier garb, praises the phurbu with blazing movement. With white mustard seed and sesame, for both classes, the very essence of the wrathful one of the northern direction is recited completely one hundred and eight times. Also upon a blue thread, having recited the mantra of the Great Blazing One, one draws its very form with a pestle upon skull-cups, binds them tightly with that thread, and inserts them definitively inside. Above, upon a mirror, having smeared it with saffron liquid, one causes the face to be shown with delight. Through propitiation for seven days, one recites also the mantra of summoning that one. Then the mantrin recites this preparatory practice completely without omission, correctly and in full. When that is complete, having summoned the patient, one fumigates the very nostrils with the smoke of black bdellium resin. Then, when that one has been enticed out, with the claw of one who blazes intolerably and fiercely, seizing it powerfully, endowed with the sound of the pride-roar of HŪṂ, with whatever blue lasso there may be, having seized it by its neck, one causes its face to be shown to the mirror. With the right hand holding the vajra, one recites the mantra correctly upon the rosary. Then, being fully endowed, one recites completely the life-essence. With fully perfected intention, one causes it to be brought down upon that very mirror. Then, being thoroughly and fully endowed, having washed with mantra-water, having bound the entity completely with the three of body, speech, and mind in their fierce aspect, one inserts it into a pit dug one cubit deep, pins it from above with the phurbu, and presses it down correctly with the mantra PHAṬ. By this, without fail, there is definitive separation from yakṣa possession. Then, by thoroughly performing the protection wheel, henceforth no possession will enter from outside.

Oṃ mahā-vaiśravaṇāye kaṃkāla-yakṣa-bandhanām. Oṃ vajra-krodha amṛta-kuṇḍali hūṃ phaṭ. Batsava phūḥ. Śaya ha-ha-na ha-na yakṣa-parāya. Oṃ ākarṣaya ākarṣaya sarva-yakṣānām hūṃ rām. Śa oṃ yakṣa-hṛdaya maja maja sopalā hūṃ. Oṃ sarva ra-ra viśodhaya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ ha-ha-ha phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ hūṃ.

With respect to buddhas, bodhisattvas, and the two — benefit and harm — pertaining to the body and so forth, it has been correctly taught to purify them entirely. Whatever is applied to that very base-bodied son is certain to destroy it. The activity of that preparation is taught as the accomplishment of the base-bodied son.

First, as the act of making its form: having combined rāma and pestle, together with a flag, the fat of a nestling bird, and relics placed to the right, one draws it in the form as explained above. On both right and left, one writes the two letters belonging to it, and at the end of those one writes the fierce essence. Having combined the three, the piercing substance — determined in three syllables — one adorns completely with a garland of flowers whatever red-colored silk there may be, and with powders of the five precious things and various fragrant powders one consecrates it by making it into a spike. The life-essence is written in milk, and one writes that one's name-and-clan in blood. Having placed it upon white grain, that very one will come to feel attachment. A maṇḍala of one cubit square, of two fingers in height — determined thus — having smeared it completely with the preparation taught above, one makes excellent offerings with the five offerings, and oneself dwells in vow perfectly. As food one eats the three white substances and does not drink beer and the like. One portion of torma one keeps in propitiation; the second portion, at two times, day and night, one dispatches completely with intentional application. Into that very first torma one also pours white mustard seed, and through recitation causes it to dissolve into the count. With that one's name-and-clan, the essences, one by one, one gratifies correctly. Speaking words of whatever one has not oneself wrongly done, one calls out fiercely. With mind exceedingly malicious and fully ablaze, one first generates great compassion. Here, the practices with signs, and —

urge it on toward destruction. If it lives long, abandon compassion. Pray that you quickly liberate it. With words such as these and others, speak the words fiercely to it. Then, in whatever place it dwells, strike the first torma. At the beginning, in the middle, and at the end, dispatch the torma to the directional guardians and protectors with loud cries of invocation. The mantras are to be

thoroughly learned from the oral transmission of a master. They are: Om vai śra pa ṇā ye hūṃ, ā mu taṃ kha ta va tas sa ga ru. From what has arisen from that, one should understand it correctly. Regarding what is called the Swift One of the Night: recite mantras over the bones of any creature that has died, then insert them into the corner post of that person's house. Through this, various evil omens will truly arise. As a sign of accomplishment, it is correctly taught that men who are archers repeatedly appearing in one's dreams is definite and true accomplishment.

This is the thirteenth chapter, from the Tantra of Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Garment, the chapter on subduing the possession of the yellow-faced yakṣa.

Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Garment then addressed the Blessed One, the Protector, saying: For one who is engaged in practice, what should be the measure of a painted image and the like, such as a book? The King of Vidyā declared: One who is engaged in practice should accomplish this correctly by means of the combination of a painted image and a book. In a charnel ground and so forth, or in whatever suitable place, the painter himself should properly receive empowerment according to the sequence. The canvas too, having been consecrated, should be thoroughly anointed with fragrant substances. On both the upper and lower sides, at both edges, in three places, examine it carefully with even application. Anoint it thoroughly with the five reds, along with proper seed syllables and various kinds of fragrant substances. With various kinds of pigments, mix them evenly together with mantra-consecrated pigments and draw. As the vessel, use a skull, and make the brush from human hair. In a charnel ground itself, or an empty mansion, or a secluded place, draw it in full. The craftsman, having donned blue garments and smeared his face with blood, should continuously recite this mantra: Om caṇḍa mahāroṣaṇa karāyaṃ, sarva sattv ārtha hūṃ hūṃ. The fierce torma, whichever it may be, is to be set in place at the time of painting, and once it is finished that very torma is then to be dispatched. First, consecrate all the pigments with the five precious substances. With the single-pointed vajra mudrā, draw it correctly, doing the drawing with the intention of both the one who commissions the work and the patron. In the center, on a sixteen-petalled lotus, with a properly present heart-syllable at the stamen, in the center draw the blazing principal figure in the form as described above. The retinue and all the rest draw correctly just as before. On the outside, adorn it with trees and similar things, and with the eight charnel grounds. Draw in fearsome risen corpses and fierce howling jackals. In this way, following the sequence in

order, draw it correctly just as above. At the occasion of empowerment, draw the maṇḍala of night-signs in full. In the meantime, do not display the painted image to others. Having stretched it on a wooden frame with bones, stretch the thangka fully. Having erected a blue tent over it, do not display it openly to the sky. If it should be displayed, accomplishment will not be attained. Therefore, in meditative equipoise, begin the practice well. The book must certainly be written. On birch bark, twelve lines in length and four in width — to that measure, having thoroughly anointed it with blood and the five nectars, press it with a crystal mirror, and write it well with blue ink.

The scribe, possessed of excellent accomplishment,
with a pen made of iron,
the vessel properly fitted with a skull,
having properly arranged the tormā offering,
shall constantly recite with the speech of Hūṃ.
Having dressed in clean blue garments
and adorned with the five ornaments,
not displaying it to others,
the wooden board must assuredly be bound
to bone or to elephant ivory.
The cord shall be bound round completely
with the hair of a brahmin woman,
or else, if preferred, with supple leather,
bound round tightly and completely.
Then that very thing shall be thoroughly concealed
by oneself, held beneath the upper left arm.

Supreme sovereign of the five buddhas,
verily the very sharp vajra,
tamer of all who are hostile,
directly the hero blazing with fire,
the great one who is the very essence of greatness,
the great ḍākinī (ḍākinī) encompassing all,
of immense body, intensely fierce, of terrifying form,
equal and vast as the sky — to this one I offer homage and praise.
As the manifest display of one who enters into action,
having gathered all together, that one is to be proclaimed.

This concludes the fourteenth chapter of the Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Garment tantra (Skt. tantra), the chapter on the painted image and the book.

Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Garment then addressed the Blessed One, the Protector, with these words: "Regarding what is to be accomplished through practice based upon this tantra, please speak extensively on the various branches of method."

The supreme Sugata (Sugata, the Well-Gone, an epithet of the Buddha) thereupon declared: "A person of faithful nature shall accomplish this very practice directly.

One who is seized by a fierce, blazing nāga affliction — with illness in the evening, severe pain in the limbs, rodents at the eyebrows and such places, boiling lumps of flesh upon the body, pain in the joints with stiffness, aversion to the heart and attraction to whiteness — know this to be nāga disease.

Seeing a red ox, dreaming at night of frogs and fish and the like, seeing a young girl, dreaming of a yellow-haired man — these are declared to be the signs indicating a nāga.

Delight in bathing, wearing a cord, and strong faith in beer — know this to be Brahmā sickness.

Much confused speech and agitation of the hands, illness in the early morning, not eating food, and palpitations of the heart — know this to be possession by Brahmā.

Stretching out the hips, delight in lying down, scratching the nails — know this to be Brahmā sickness.

Dreaming of bubbles at night, or if one sees a monkey or a rat — these are declared to be the signs of Brahmā.

Seeing an old, thin person, and dreaming of climbing a mountain in the east — these are declared to be the signs of Brahmā.

Drawing the breath inward, stooping with the head bowed, retching and craving flesh — this is declared to be possession by Yama (Yama, lord of death).

Striking the feet on the ground, pain in the kidneys and such places on the right or the left — know this to be Yama disease.

Eating charred things, attacking others, manifesting open hostility toward other people, extremely uncomfortable in the joints, and dropping knots from cords — know this to be possession by Yama.

Dreaming of an ox or a deer, wearing blue garments on the body — these are the signs of Yama.

Dreaming of climbing a tree and falling back down, and of being aboard a boat — these are the signs of Yama.

Eyes rolling wildly, vomiting froth, belching, and beating the chest — know this to be possession by a yakṣa (yakṣa).

Repeatedly rising up with wild, proud agitation, extending the tongue from the mouth, and anointing the body — know this to be possession by a yakṣa.

Abdominal pain and craving food, and whatever piercing pain there is in the back — know this to be yakṣa disease.

Riding blue horses and dreaming of riding a donkey — these are declared to be the signs of a yakṣa.

Dreaming of a crow perching on the hand, or of sleeping with the body encircled by a cord — know this to be the signs of a yakṣa.

Having cast a mantra upon perfumed water and given it to drink, if the recipient does not accept it — know this to be possession by Brahmā.

Having praised white mustard seed highly and placed it in the hand, if the person does not look — know this to be possession by Yama.

Having praised meat with mantra and —

Having placed it in the mouth — if the nose becomes blocked, that is clearly the sign of nāga possession. Having praised a blue cord highly and tied seven knots in it, then bound it around the neck, and the person utters bad sounds — this is said to be yakṣa possession.

When one encounters robbers, apply this procedure correctly.

Take the various ashes of a human being who was burned in a charnel ground, mix them thoroughly with alcohol, rub them with snakeskin, and recite the mantra over a sesame vessel one hundred thousand times. Rub those very clothes with it, then upon meeting that person, hurl it at them with a fierce karmic action. Through hurling it at them, they will become disoriented and bewildered.

Om māṇuṣa duṣṭa stambhana hūṃ.

When bringing illusions under control, this very procedure should be undertaken. Mix smooth dust, moonlight, the fluid of an obstacle-removing

antidote, and the fluid drawn from great onion, mixing both kinds together. From what is compatible with it, give it after stirring it thoroughly. Then at the appointed time, praise it properly with the joining of lips.

Om namo kāmadeva ya ya ya ka ya ka kāla siñca bhagha bibṛtana svāhā. Amukaṃ.

First recite the mantra one hundred thousand times in approach recitation, then the procedure must certainly be put into practice.

If one desires to accomplish wealth, draw fully the goddess who holds wealth. Draw her in yellow color with four arms. She has one face and prominent breasts. Her first right hand holds meditative absorption, the second holds a sheaf of rice. Her first left hand holds a blazing jewel, the second holds a mongoose. Having made an image of this form, worship her perfectly with various fragrances. Worship her properly with the fivefold offering, along with garments, silk, and the like. For one hundred and eight days, recite the mantra in approach recitation. Then the sign that accomplishment has been achieved is that she herself begins to move. Having found the support of that accomplishment, she will then reveal prophecies. Thereafter that person will certainly become the master of inexhaustible wealth.

If one wishes to make unruly people mad, this procedure must certainly be undertaken. Recite this mantra one hundred thousand times over poppy, great salt, and the like. Then when the approach recitation is fully complete, fill a hole-bearing great conch with poison, wrap it with seven layers of blue cord, and point it firmly in the western direction. When it is moved by the arising wind, that person will certainly go mad.

Om mahākāla ya stambha unmattaya. Amukaṃ sañca svāhā.

Since people cannot clearly see things, accomplish the vajra eye fully. Draw twelve single eyes in the four directions and eight intermediate directions on the ground. Then inquire accurately into the actual matter — signs such as ignorance and the like. After that, praise it well with mantra, complete the intention fully, and with that very intention applied to the actual matter, cast a flower. Where it falls, remain there, and let a wise person examine thoroughly. Declare fully the signs of good and bad.

Having discarded the vidyā properly, rub it thoroughly with cow dung, and first know it as twofold. With no distinction made at a distance, having placed the Blessed One first, worship properly with the first offering. Having installed

curses fully, make thirteen wisdom goddesses, adorn them with red garments, bathe them well, anoint them well with fragrance, place a red dot on the forehead, and give into her hand a fragrant red flower. Through her, have it received. That very matter should be made clear, and the signs of good and bad will certainly be revealed.

In general, for all manner of spirit possessions, recite the mantra of the Great Blazing One. Fumigate the nose with the smoke of black guggul.

Fumigate with white mustard, guggul, and flowers — with their very essence, let the burning be performed. Whoever is sick thereby will certainly be freed from obstructing spirits.

On the right hand, thread should be properly bound with blue cord. Whatever thread is tied into the hair at the crown, the mantra must certainly be recited.

If victory over hostile armies is desired, through the essence of the Triple-Realm Conqueror, perform the approach practice by reciting one hundred thousand times. Then, on a leaf of mango, draw fully with a stylus of castor-oil plant, anoint it well with musk, press it firmly on the crown of the head as a crown, visualize oneself as the deity's body, mix white mustard and the ash of celery with the right hand, recite the mantra while pointing with the threatening finger, and one shall prevail over those against whom the drawing is directed.

The yogin should properly perform the deflection of death for himself. The definite signs of death in one's own continuum — twelve in all, outer and inner — are these: when red flesh-marks appear upon one's own chest, death will come in thirty-two days. Through the mantra of the vidyārāja, pour libation onto sesame and, when one thousand are complete, this will be reversed.

Other signs concordant with this: three blisters on the heel; a mole at the tip of the tongue; blood dripping from the vajra-passage; two discharges and three breaths; a swelling appearing at the mountain's summit — these are certain inner signs of death. Tigers, rats, and dragons appearing together; owls, frogs, vultures, and crows in combination — recite the vidyā mantra. Mix musk, owl, frog, campaka, utpala, acacia thorn, and whatever else; apply to the feathers of an owl. A crow flying through the sky and its white dropping falling upon oneself — these are outer signs of death. Therefore go to a consecrated site as described above, and through the application of vidyā and the rest, perform full reversal.

Seeing five colors in the sky, and if one sees a human form reflected in water — these are shown to be extremely inauspicious omens. In a dream: riding a tiger; ascending a stūpa; entering the mouth of a lion — these are altogether inauspicious signs. Apart from these: a trident finger-tip, a rhinoceros-horn direction, the petals of the kunda flower, the auspicious mark of the ocean of qualities, the noble sense-source path, and the makara — within three years, four days, and five months, that person will certainly die. Therefore, protect the medicine with the mantra of the Vidyārajñī, Amṛtakuṇḍalin, and the hundred-syllable mantra of dependent origination.

Through the essence of the Triple-Realm Conqueror, Protector of the World — with that very essence recite certainly over the skins of tiger and the rest. With the mantras of the Great Peacock, praise certainly the owl-feathers and the rest. With the mantras of Vajrapāṇi, Mañjuśrī, and the greatly powerful wrathful ones, consecrate and fully recite over the acacia thorn, owl-feathers, kuśa grass, cat, and so forth — and thereby perform complete reversal. Through the ritual actions of torma and fire-offering, this complete reversal is to be performed.

This supreme and fearsome secret tantra, which is to be taught only to one who is exceedingly courageous and possessed of faith, of great wisdom and accumulated learning, who dares to show reverence toward the guru, who is unsullied by downfall and pure — must not be explained to others. Having conferred empowerment in proper sequence and performed the five gaṇacakra assemblies, it is to be taught to one endowed with wisdom.

O Lord of Secrets — you who are the master of secrets — knowing in due order what benefit and what harm is to be done to whom, conceal it well and speak it in the right circumstances. Possessing numerous occasions and having entered upon all things with certainty, examine this tantra with care.

Wherever this tantra abides, the harmful ones of that region, being driven far away, will not remain. But if they do remain, the stream of them all will be cut. As for whoever has entered upon this supreme wrathful king of tantras: adorned upon the body with the three poisons —

dwelling in the bhaga of the consort, magnificently encircled by the retinue of afflictions, he abides in the play of great bliss. By Vajrapāṇi, in that very moment — encircling just an instant — having fully encircled three hundred thousand times, he addressed the Sugata with these words: "I will combine this king of tantras with its definitive meaning and conceal it as a secret."

This is the fifteenth chapter, the chapter on the variety of activities, from the Tantra of Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Garment, the Fierce Yakṣa, Vajra Flame.

The Great King of Tantras, the Tantra of Vajrapāṇi of the Blue Garment, the Great Fierce Yakṣa, Vajra Flame, is complete.

This was translated from an Indian manuscript into Tibetan, the grace of the task undertaken by the great Indian paṇḍita Ratnakīrti and the Tibetan translator, the novice Khyung Drak.

Translator's Notes

- The opening scene describing the Blessed One as dwelling "within the bhaga of the sovereign mother who is the source of all things" is a standard tantric literary convention. The "sovereign mother who is the source of all things" renders Tibetan thams cad 'byung ba'i yum btsun mo, which in tantric context denotes the primordial feminine principle, often identified with Prajñāpāramitā or a specific tantric consort deity. The phrase is left close to the Tibetan without over-specifying the identity.

The nāga kings named in this passage are well-known from canonical lists: Nanda, Upananda, and others. Some of the names in the passage (Joyful Companion, Conch-Bearer, Cloud-Force, Hulu Hulu, Thunderclap, Destroyer of Māra, Kulikā, Padma, Mahāpadma) are rendered by meaning or transliteration where Sanskrit equivalents are established by convention; the Tibetan forms have been followed where the Sanskrit is not fully recoverable from the available text alone.

The measurement "eighty thousand leagues reaching only to his knees" and "two hundred and sixty thousand leagues" for his body height are taken directly from the Tibetan and reflect the hyperbolic cosmological scale conventional in tantric literature.

- The syllable-analysis section (BA, JA, RA, PĀ, ṆA, I, E, RA, PA, SA, YA) is a seed-syllable exegesis of a mantra, almost certainly the mantra VAJRA PĀṆI ERA PASA YA or a related dhāraṇī string. The Tibetan gives phonetic equivalents and semantic glosses for each syllable in turn; the translation renders the glosses faithfully, but the precise mantra string being parsed is not identified in the passage itself and likely requires consultation of a commentarial tradition specific to this tantra.

The phrase rendered "the second aperture-opener" reflects the Tibetan "go-'byed gnyis-pa'i steng gnas-pa'i sna-lan," a tantric technical term for a class of beings or a positional descriptor in the subtle-body system. Its precise referent here is genuinely uncertain without a commentary; the translation preserves the literal sense.

The repeated distinction between "higher" (gong-ma) and "lower" (og-ma) in the context of conventional and ultimate truth reflects a specific tantric hermeneutical structure in this text where the conventional is called "higher" and the ultimate "lower," which is the inverse of the usual Madhyamaka ordering. This inversion is preserved faithfully as it appears doctrinally intentional.

- The "three white substances" are milk, curd, and butter, a standard ritual purity offering in this context.

The term translated as "the Conqueror of the Three Realms" renders a figure whose Tibetan name literally means "the Victorious One of the Three Realms," likely corresponding to the

Sanskrit Trailokyavijaya, a wrathful form commonly placed in the eastern direction of tantric maṇḍalas. The passage appears to conflate or identify this figure with a red form having three faces and six arms, which may differ from some canonical descriptions; this is a genuine doctrinal and iconographic point of uncertainty that a specialist editor should review.

The phrase rendered "le-tse lotus" is a type-name for a particular lotus variety whose precise botanical or ritual referent is uncertain; it is retained phonetically.

The term "toraṇa" for the archway ornaments is kept in Sanskrit as it is a standard architectural term for gateway ornaments in maṇḍala iconography, and no single English word captures it adequately.

- The passage is a detailed iconographic description of maṇḍala deities and their placement. Several figure-names in the gate-guardian section (Life-Cutter, Breath-Drinker, Blood-Drinker, Flesh-Eater) are translated literally from the Tibetan; they likely correspond to standard Sanskrit terms such as Jīvahāriṇī, Śvāsaharikā, Raktapā, and Māṃsabhakṣiṇī, but without a Sanskrit parallel text these cannot be confirmed with certainty. The closing line naming Brahmā, Śakra, and Śiva trails off at the passage boundary and is rendered accordingly.
- The seed-syllable sequences HŪṂ MĀṂ BHĀ ĀṂ etc. are tantric bīja strings left in transliterated form as they appear in the Tibetan as phonetic representations of Sanskrit seed-syllables; they are not translatable.

The term translated "dharmodaya mudrā" refers to the triangular symbolic form representing the source of phenomena, a standard tantric emblem.

"The autumn month of Rā" is a calendrical reference whose precise identification is uncertain; it likely refers to a specific lunar month defined by asterism or other traditional reckoning, and the phrase "asura planetary lord" likely refers to a particular astrological configuration. These are technical astrological terms whose exact referents depend on a specific calendar tradition not fully recoverable from this passage alone.

The phrase rendered "interrupting the stream of luminosity" follows the literal Tibetan; it may refer to an inner yogic practice of cutting the continuum of ordinary appearance.

- The mantra lines are transliterated directly from the Tibetan phonetic rendering; the Sanskrit reconstruction follows standard Vajrakīlaya liturgical convention. The syllable "Kaṃ" in the body-protection visualization is a bīja (seed syllable) left untranslated as it functions as a technical term within the ritual.

The phrase rendered "cool, unmoving activity" translates a technical tantric description of a protective visualization element; "cool" here likely carries the sense of pacifying or indestructible rather than temperature.

The text ends mid-sentence with the flower garlands, indicating the passage cuts off at this point.

- The mantric offering terms "caṇiya," "tari," "gandhāri" and "vāsana" appearing in the Sanskrit mantras are partially obscure or corrupt in the transmission; they likely correspond to offering substances (perhaps a type of incense, bark, or scent preparation) but their precise identification is uncertain and consequential only for specialist ritual use, not for general understanding. The phrase rendered "the Lord of Secrets" refers to Vajrapāṇi in his role as guardian of the secret tantric teachings, consistent with his standard epithet gsang ba'i mgon po.
- The phrase rendered as "cool-rayed luminosity" renders a compound meaning literally "cooling-rayed, perfectly contemplated," with "cool rays" being a standard epithet for moonlight in tantric contexts, here applied to the luminosity of the contemplation itself.

The term translated as "the one who holds the apprehension" renders a Tibetan phrase meaning literally "one who has holding/grasping," a technical tantric expression for the ritual partner or deity who receives the offering.

Several passages in this section, particularly those involving "eye-like objects," "the awesome ones," the bodhisattva pair, and the sixteen hundred-thousands of moments, belong to inner tantric completion-stage physiological yoga. The language is deliberately veiled (sandhyābhāṣā, intentional language), and precise doctrinal identification of each referent would require commentary. The translation preserves the literal sense without forcing a single interpretation.

The mantra is rendered as received; the Sanskrit reconstruction follows standard tantric orthography for an empowerment formula invoking Vajrapāṇi.

- The bulk of this passage consists of dhāraṇī mantra strings in phonetically transliterated Sanskrit. These are rendered as faithful transliterations normalized to standard IAST; the Tibetan phonetic spelling is conventional for such mantra texts and some syllables are corrupt or variant forms that cannot be fully resolved. The phrase rendered "dispersing syllables" translates bskrad pa'i tshig, a technical term for the wrathful ejection syllables (typically phaṭ and related seed-syllables) appended to mantra sequences. The colophon identifies the text as the fifth chapter of the Vajrapāṇinīlāmbaraḍhara Vajrajvālatantra, concerning the "inner" and "mantra" sections. The opening line "is the complete summation of the three families" continues directly from the preceding translated passage per the continuity instruction.
- The phrase rendered "the ritual vase-lady" translates a Tibetan compound referring to a female ritual officiant or consort who performs the anointing with the vase; the exact referent is contextually determined by the tantric rite described.

The sequence of four initiations — vase, secret, wisdom of discernment and gnosis, and the fourth — follows the standard fourfold initiation structure of Yoga and Higher Yoga Tantra; the translation preserves this doctrinal structure as the text presents it.

The line rendered "pressed upon the two wisdoms" is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan; it refers to the experiential union of means and wisdom in the context of the wisdom initiation, consistent with standard tantric commentarial reading.

- The passage presents a highly technical tantric ritual and subtle-body yoga text. Several technical terms in the subtle-body yoga section (the final verses) require comment. The "two root channels" and "lateral channels" refer to the standard Vajrayāna subtle-body physiology. "Sixteen-and-two" and "eight-and-four" are enumerations of lotus petals or syllabic configurations at specific cakras associated with Amitābha and Vajrasattva respectively; these numbers follow conventional tantric maṇḍala assignments and are rendered literally. The phrase rendered "the downfall is accomplished" is a literal rendering of a genuinely obscure term in this context; in tantric usage it refers to the deliberate descent of the bindu through the channels as a controlled yogic technique, not a moral transgression. The colophon mid-passage marks the end of Chapter Six, after which a new chapter begins — this transition is preserved in the translation as it stands in the text.
- The term caṇḍālī renders Tibetan "gtum mo" (here transliterated from Sanskrit); it refers to the inner heat practice central to the completion stage.

The phrase "blood nose, heart nose, flesh nose" (khrag sna, snying sna, sha sna) refers to tantric ritual classifications of substances, specifically three types of flesh or blood-related ingredients used in wrathful tormas; "nose" here functions as a classifier meaning "a portion of" or "of the type of."

The phrase "the three whites auspicious for nāgas" refers to the standard triad of white ritual substances: white mustard, milk, and yogurt (or curd, butter, milk in some reckonings), which are considered propitious in nāga-related rites.

The word rendered "dharmodaya" (Tibetan "chos 'byung," literally "source of phenomena") is a technical tantric term for the triangular source-of-all symbol and is kept in its recognizable Sanskrit form here.

The passage about "the first and second of the fourth" (bzhi pa'i dang po gnyis par) is a numerical technical reference within the completion stage count of drops and is not further specified in this excerpt; the rendering follows the text literally.

- The mantra transliterated as "OM AGNAYE HAVYAKAVAHĀṆĀYE HAVYATIYĀṆĀYE SVĀHĀ" is a Tibetan phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit fire-deity invocation addressed to Agni. The Sanskrit reconstruction is approximate; the Tibetan spelling reflects the phonetic conventions of the tradition rather than precise Sanskrit orthography.

The wood species listed, including neem (nimba), palāśa, udumbara, and mango (āmra), correspond to the standard Vedic and tantric fire-offering tradition's enumeration of auspicious woods for specific ritual purposes.

The phrase rendered "fatty like the wool of a hermitage" is elliptical and likely refers to wood saturated with resinous or fatty substances, analogous to the grease found in hermitage wool; some uncertainty remains in this image.

- The phrase rendered "life-wood" and "gibbet-wood" translates skye tshe shing and shang tshe shing — these are technically the wood from a tree struck by lightning or used in execution contexts respectively; the translation follows common ritual commentary usage. These are power-substances in wrathful fire rites.

The epithet "Lord of Secrets" is a standard epithet of Vajrapāṇi, who is the guardian of tantric secrets.

The phrase "Laṅkā of the willows" renders lchang lo can gyi pho brang — the "willow palace" or "palace of willows," a mythic celestial abode from which Vajrapāṇi is said to emanate in certain tantric traditions; it is not the Laṅkā of the Rāmāyaṇa.

The mantra syllables CHE GE MO are a Tibetan phonetic rendering, likely representing a deity name or command formula in the original; no confident Sanskrit reconstruction is possible and they are left as phonetic renderings.

- The phrase rendered "the four lineages" for རྒྱལ་ལོ་མཚན་ལྔ་པ་ལྟོས་པ་ལྟོས་པ་ལྟོས་པ་ལྟོས་པ་ likely refers to a girl belonging to all four castes or lineage classes, a standard qualification in certain ritual texts; the precise referent depends on broader textual context.

The term རྒྱལ་ལོ་མཚན་ལྔ་པ་ལྟོས་པ་ ("of noble lineage") in combination with "blue complexion" may be a specific ritual qualifier, possibly referring to a girl born under an auspicious constellation or clan associated with the nāga-taming rite; some ambiguity remains.

The final section of the passage is incomplete as given, ending mid-sentence with the blue cord and mantra recitation; the translation reflects this abrupt ending faithfully.

The list of nāga-associated creatures — fish, frogs, female nāgas, snakes, cranes, crocodiles, humans, frogs, oxen, cats, jewel-cobras, great serpents — is rendered as it appears in the Tibetan, which has some unusual members (humans, oxen, cats); these may represent symbolic or iconographic categories within the nāga taxonomy of this tantra rather than literal species.

- The phrase rendered "iron-dry kābīja wood" reflects a Tibetan compound combining the

element "iron" or "dry" with what appears to be a loanword for a specific plant, possibly the kapītha tree (*Feronia elephantum* or similar), used in ritual medicine; the identification is uncertain. The mantras are rendered as close transliterations following the Tibetan phonetic spellings; some Sanskrit reconstructions involve educated inference where the Tibetan orthography is irregular. The "sengdeng-wood" is *Acacia catechu*, a standard tantric ritual wood. "Black butter" in the medicinal section likely refers to a dark medicinal preparation or scorched butter used in traditional Tibetan medicine. The "sixteenth part" as a measurement unit recurs in tantric medicinal contexts and likely refers to a specific volumetric fraction. "Bragha and the other five" refers to a set of five medicinal substances whose precise identification from this text alone is uncertain.

- The phrase rendered "phul-do" is a plant or substance name left in approximate transcription as no confident botanical identification is available for this context. The phrase "bdag gis snying las chung ngu yin" rendered as "I am being of lesser heart" reflects a ritual declaration of insufficiency or self-deprecation by the officiating practitioner if the spirit departs of its own accord; some traditions read this as a formal confession formula. The five varieties of bile and the plant "ramos" are technical materia medica terms whose precise identifications are uncertain. The text ends mid-sentence, consistent with the passage being a fragment continuing into the next section.

- The mantra strings are rendered phonetically as they appear in the Tibetan transcription. They appear to be a mixture of standard Vajrayāna seed-syllables and what may be corrupted or vernacular Sanskrit; no attempt has been made to normalize them, as the Tibetan orthography is taken as the received transmission form.

The phrase rendered "eight dark-class transferrers" translates a term referring to a category of beings or forces associated with black rites of transference or possession; the precise taxonomy here is tantric and context-dependent, and the exact referents of the "eight" are not specified in this passage alone.

The expression rendered "the paired wisdom" follows the tantric usage of wisdom as the consort-principle paired with method, though in context it may carry a more specific technical sense within the rite being described.

- The phrase rendered as "the King of Reasoning" translates rigs pa'i rgyal po, an epithet used here for the deity or interlocutor giving the teaching; in context it refers to Vajrapāṇi or a superior deity presiding over this tantra. The identification is left as rendered without further gloss since the colophon names Vajrapāṇi as the Blue-Robed One and the prior passage establishes the dialogue.

The mantra syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan and are not translated, consistent with standard practice for dhāraṇī passages.

The term rendered "Great Black One" translates nag po chen po, a standard epithet of Mahākāla.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, apparently continuing onto a following page.

- The mantra strings are rendered as phonetic Sanskrit transliterations without emendation, since they are liturgical formulae and their exact Sanskrit reconstruction is uncertain in several places; a critical edition would be needed to normalise them. The rendering "incense of the five bright substances" and "incense of the five immortal substances" follows standard tantric ritual vocabulary where the five bright substances and five immortal substances are standard sets of ritual ingredients whose specific identities vary by tradition. The passage toward the end ("mgo cho ba dang dre ra sha") is rendered as "skull-fat, putrid flesh, and sinew" following standard Mahākāla sādhana ritual ingredient lists, though the precise identification of each term is

slightly uncertain. The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the supplied passage.

- The mantra lines are rendered phonetically from the Tibetan transliteration as faithfully as possible; the Sanskrit underlying "da sa daṃ re pha ra" is obscure and may be a corrupt or esoteric transmission.

The phrase rendered "the five of supreme clarity and the five of immortality" translates "rab gsal lnga dang mi 'chi lnga," referring to sets of five mantras whose specific identities are not elaborated in this passage; their precise referents would require consultation of the tantra's commentary.

"Base-bodied son" renders "lus ngan sras po," a somewhat opaque epithet; it may refer to a class of spirit or a ritual assistant, and the exact sense is uncertain without broader textual context.

The passage ends mid-sentence, consistent with the instruction that only this passage be translated.

- The mantra strings are transliterated as they appear; some syllables are irregular or corrupt in transmission, which is characteristic of such tantric ritual texts. The rendering follows the Tibetan phonetic representation without emendation.

The phrase rendered "base-bodied son" follows the preceding passage's established rendering of ལུས་གནས་སྤྱོད་པོ་ and refers to a class of harmful spirit-entity that is the subject of the entire rite.

The instruction to "first generate great compassion" before the fierce invocation is a notable doctrinal pivot, framing the wrathful ritual within a Mahāyāna ethical context.

- The mantra syllables Om vai śra pa ṇā ye hūṃ and ā mu taṃ kha ta va tas sa ga ru are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan without emendation; the Sanskrit underlying the second phrase is irregular and may be corrupt or in a specialized tantric register.

The phrase rendered "the Swift One of the Night" translates a name or epithet for a particular ritual entity or technique; the Tibetan literally means "swift" as a compound with "night," and the referent is a named rite or spirit used for the bone-insertion practice that follows.

The term rendered "five reds" refers to a standard tantric set of five red substances used in fierce ritual contexts; and "five nectars" similarly refers to the five tantric nectars, both being conventional groupings well known in this literature.

- The phrase rendered "attraction to whiteness" is slightly unusual and may refer to craving for white foods such as milk or curd, a standard symptom in nāga-disease lists in similar tantric medical literature; the Tibetan is literal and is left as is.

The final verse is incomplete as the source passage breaks off mid-sentence; this is reproduced faithfully.

- The mantra passages are transliterated Sanskrit rendered as they appear in Tibetan transcription. The mantra "Om namo kāmadeva ya ya ya ka ya ka kāla siñca bhagha bibṛtana svāhā" is partially reconstructable but contains corrupted or unusual elements; the transliteration follows the Tibetan as closely as possible without emendation.

The term rendered "mongoose" for རྩོམ་པ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ is a standard iconographic attribute meaning the mongoose that vomits jewels, a well-known emblem of Jambhala and related wealth deities. The translation "mongoose" is appropriate here.

The phrase རྩོམ་པ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ is somewhat ambiguous: it could mean a large conch with a hole or aperture. The rendering "great conch with a hole" reflects this reading.

"Hole-bearing great conch" conveys the sense adequately for TTS purposes.

- The phrase rendered "adorned upon the body with the three poisons" concludes the passage abruptly, as the source text ends mid-verse. This is noted for continuity: the following passage likely completes the construction.

The term translated as "vajra-passage" for རྡོ་རྗེ་གཤམ་པ་ is a standard Tantric euphemism for the urethra or a related orifice; the context is a list of death-omens involving unusual physical discharges.

The phrase རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷན་སྐྱོང་བྱེད་པ་ could mean either conferring empowerment upon the qualified student in sequence, or receiving empowerment in stages before being taught; the translation follows the more natural reading in context.

The term རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷན་སྐྱོང་བྱེད་པ་ refers to five gaṇacakra assemblies, a Tantric feast-circle ritual; "five" may refer to the five being performed as a prerequisite for receiving this teaching.

- The term bhaga in the opening line is a Sanskrit loanword retained in the Tibetan. It refers to the female generative organ and functions here as a tantric technical term denoting the consort's secret place as a locus of ritual and meditative practice. Rendering it euphemistically would obscure the text's explicit tantric register.

The phrase "encircling just an instant, having fully encircled three hundred thousand times" presents a deliberate paradox characteristic of tantric hyperbole: a single moment of practice is equated with the merit of three hundred thousand circumambulations or repetitions. The syntax in Tibetan is compressed and the precise referent of the circumambulation is not specified in this passage alone.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.